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Moore et al.

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(54) **ALIGNMENT GUIDE**

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See application file for complete search history.

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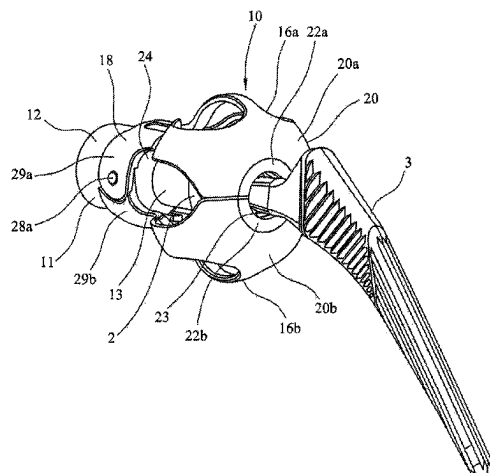
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

An orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly includes a head part of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis component and an alignment guide. The head part has a spherical bearing surface for articulation with a corresponding joint surface, and an assembly surface having a first bore formed in it for receiving a spigot on another part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis. The bore has a first axis that extends perpendicular to the assembly surface. The alignment guide has an axial portion defining a second axis and an arm extending from the axial portion. The arm includes a distal portion which is configured to engage the assembly surface, with the axial portion being arranged to engage the bearing surface of the head part when the head part is mounted within the guide

(Continued)



such that an impact force applied along the second axis is directed along the first axis.

11 Claims, 17 Drawing Sheets

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 (2013.01); *A61F 2002/4627* (2013.01); *A61F*
2002/4628 (2013.01); *A61F 2002/4681*
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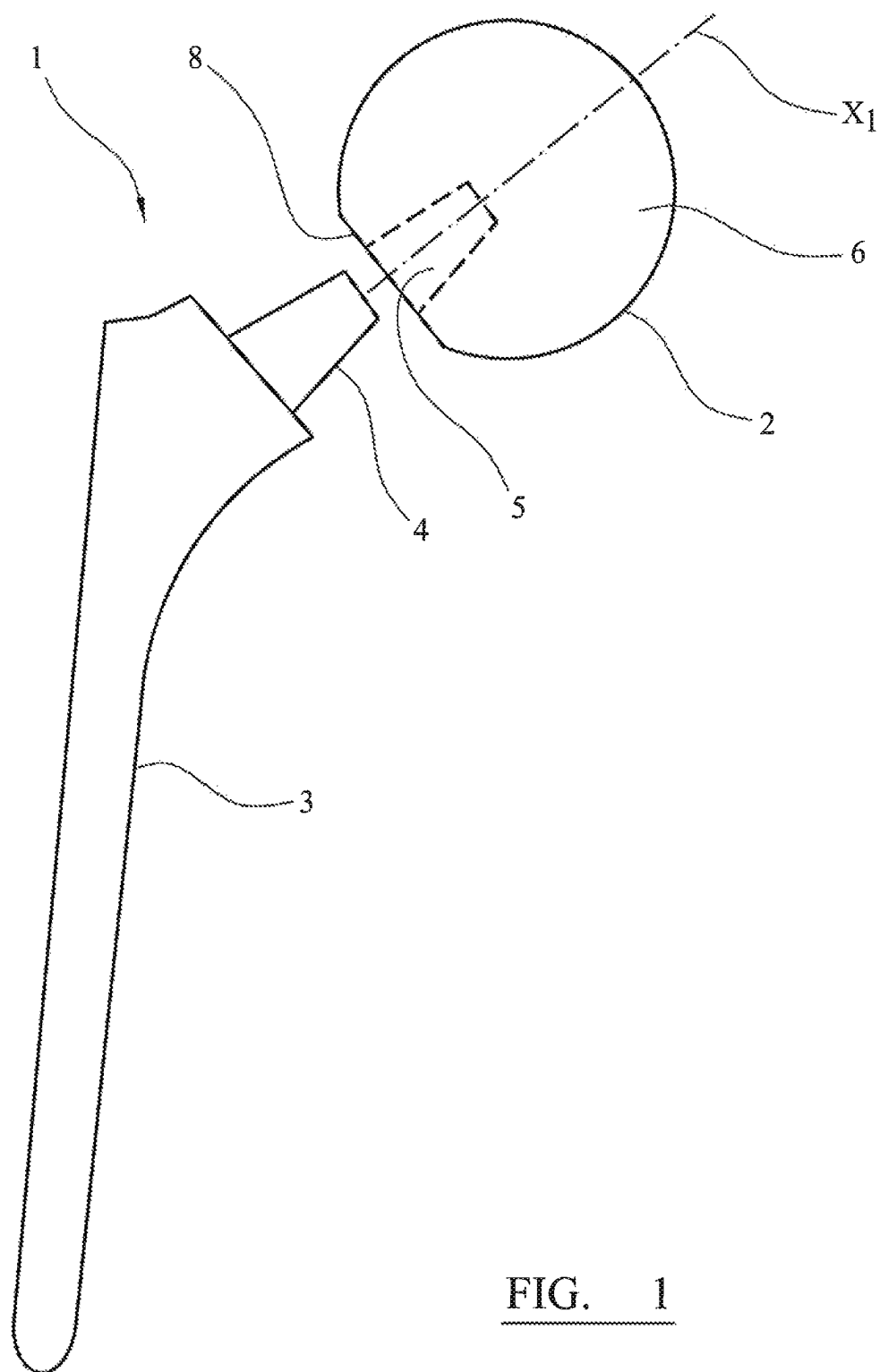
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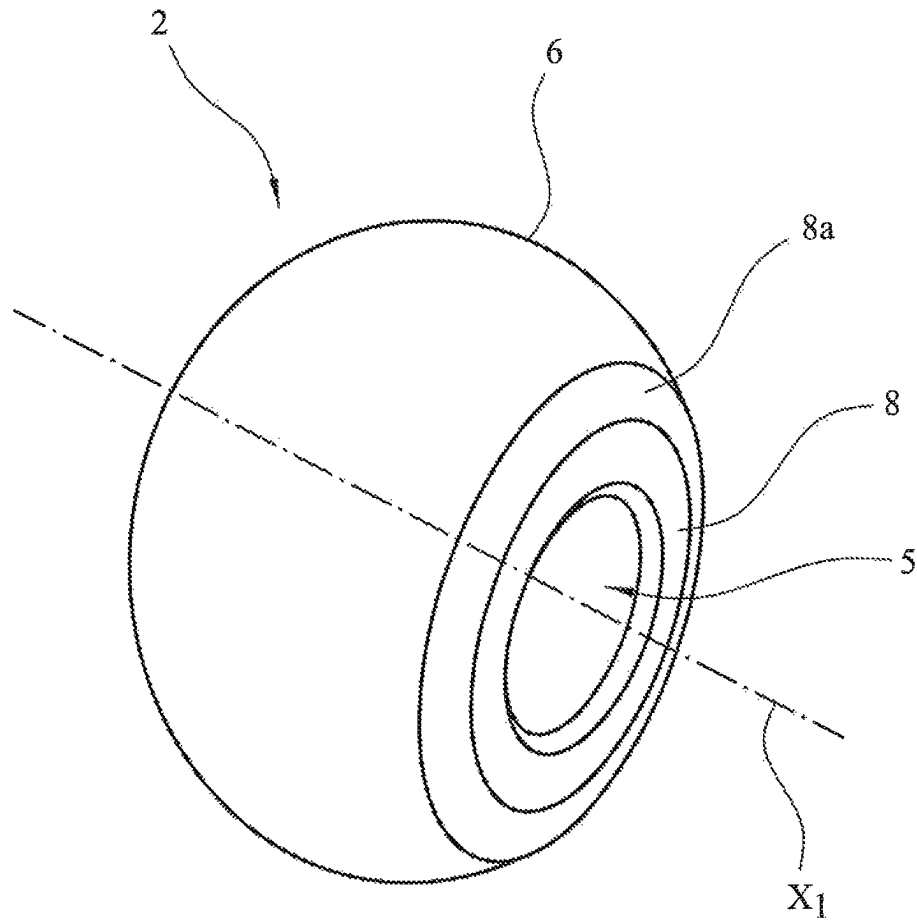


FIG. 2

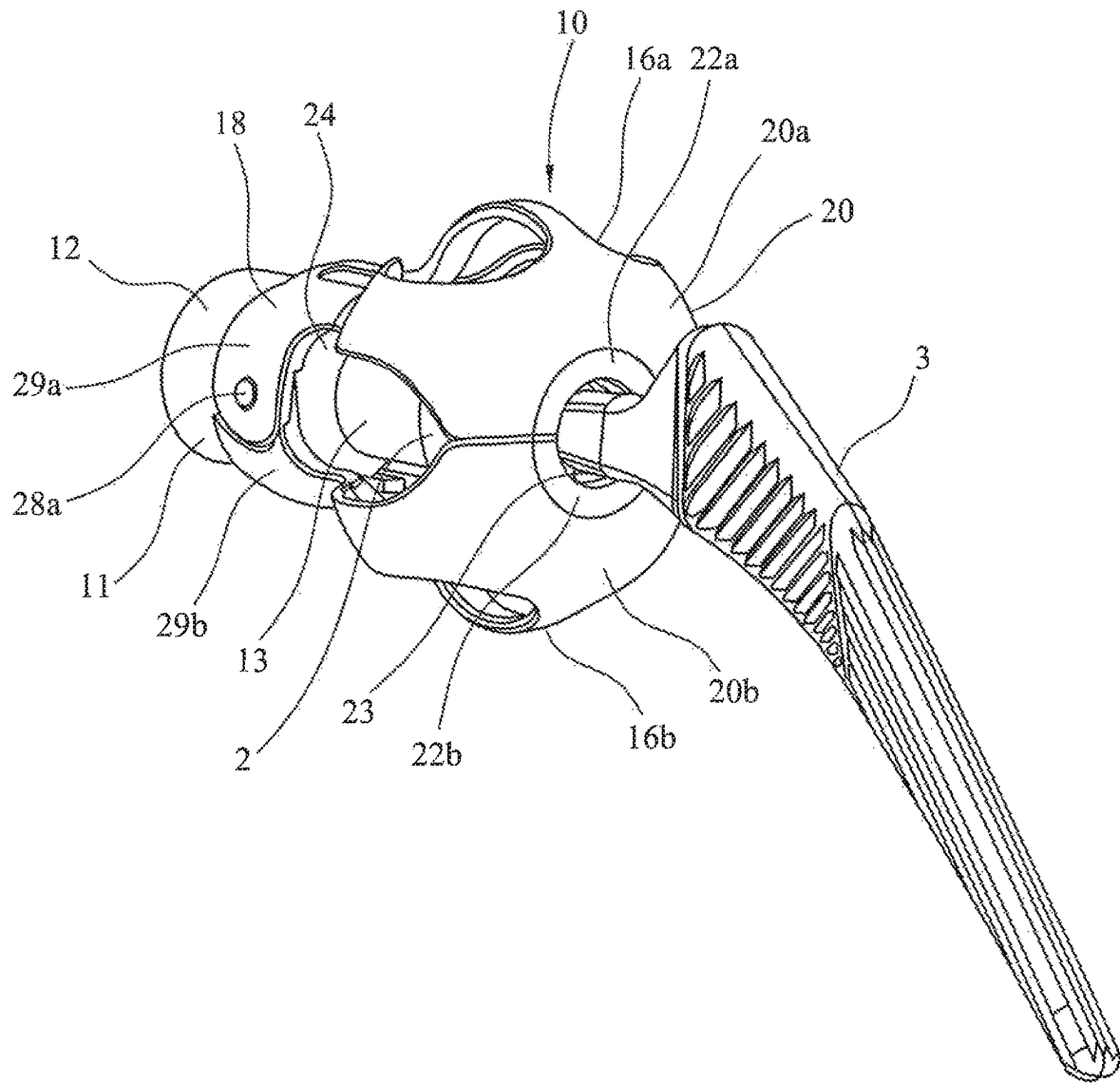


FIG. 3

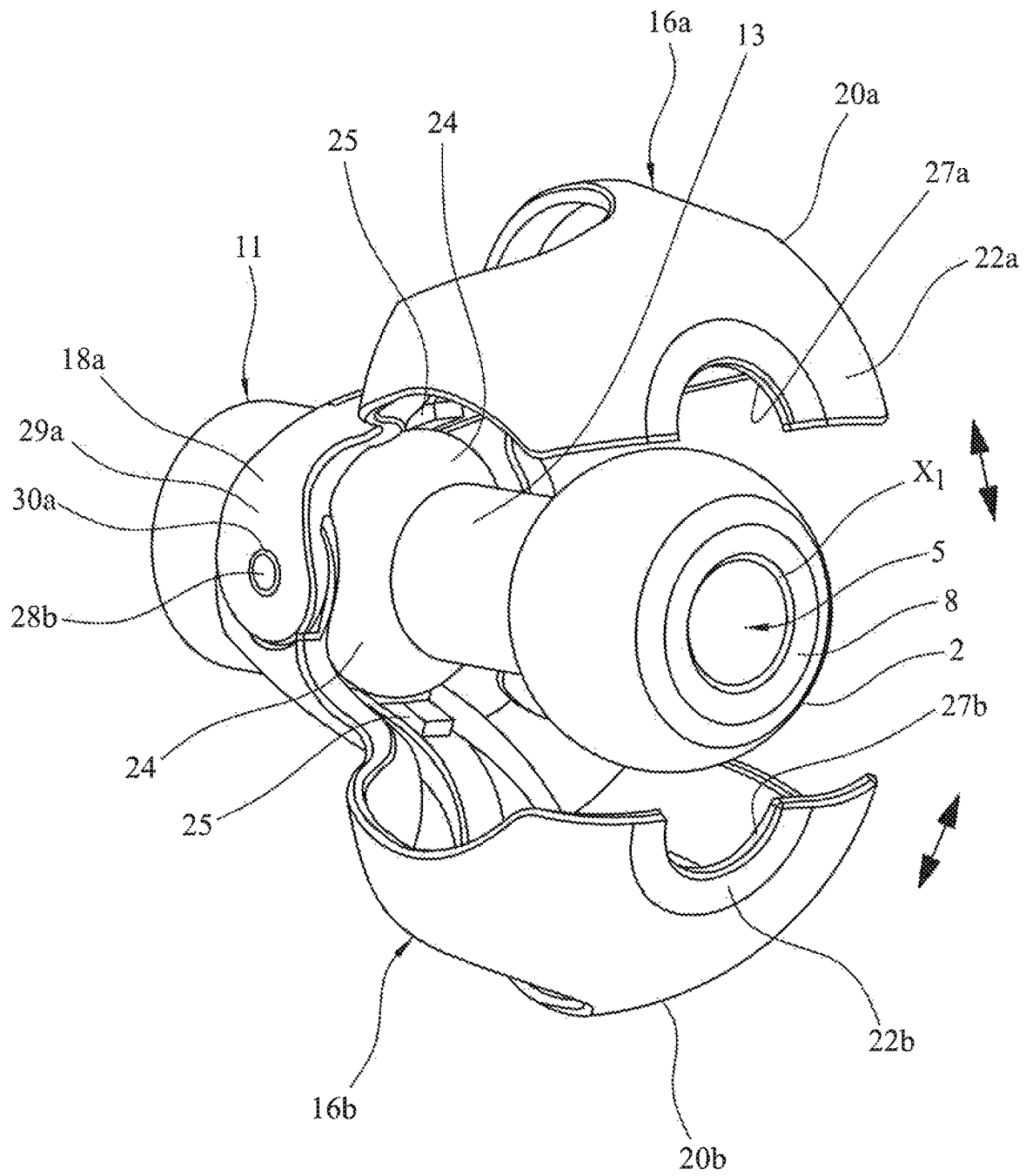


FIG. 4

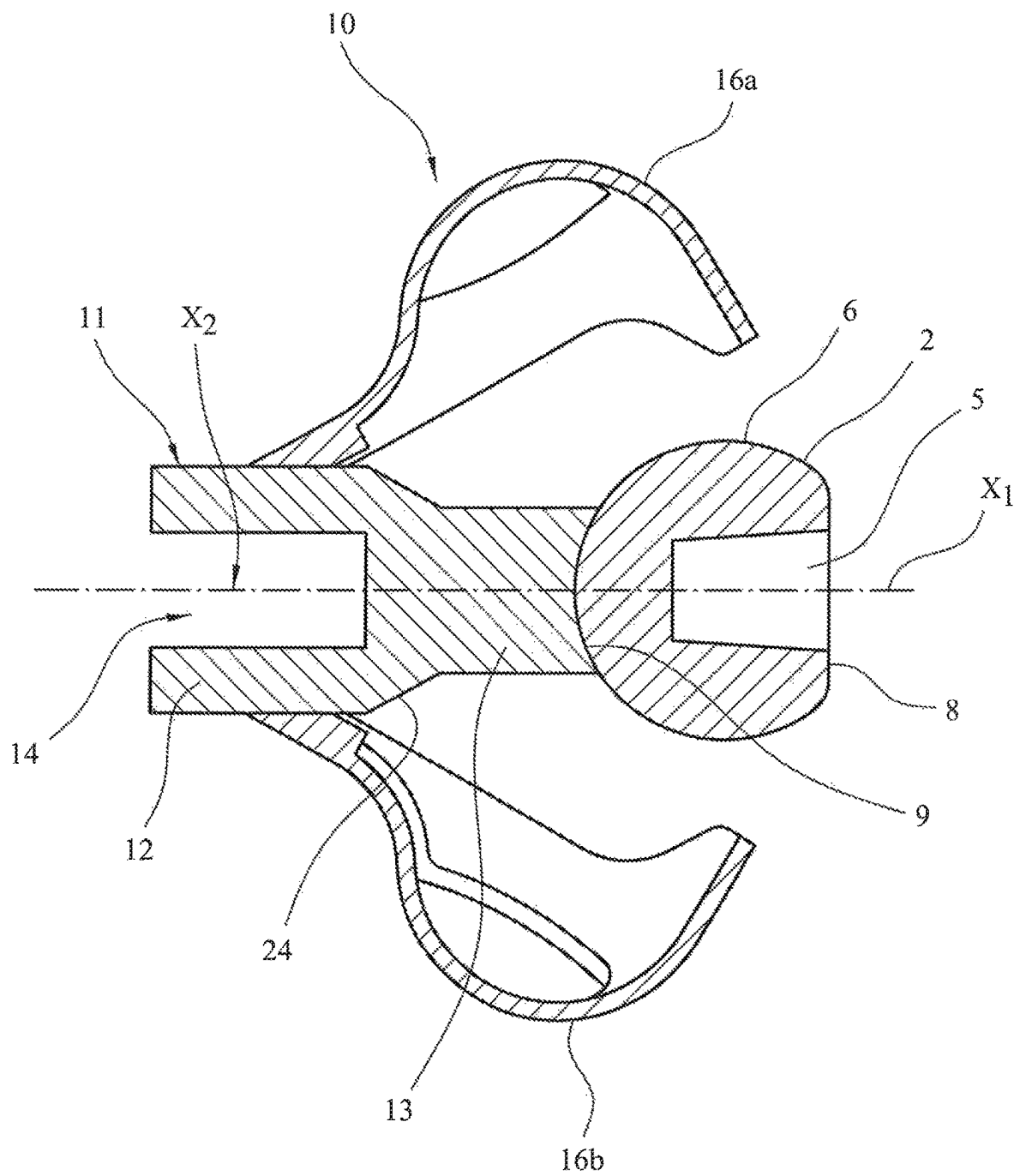


FIG. 5

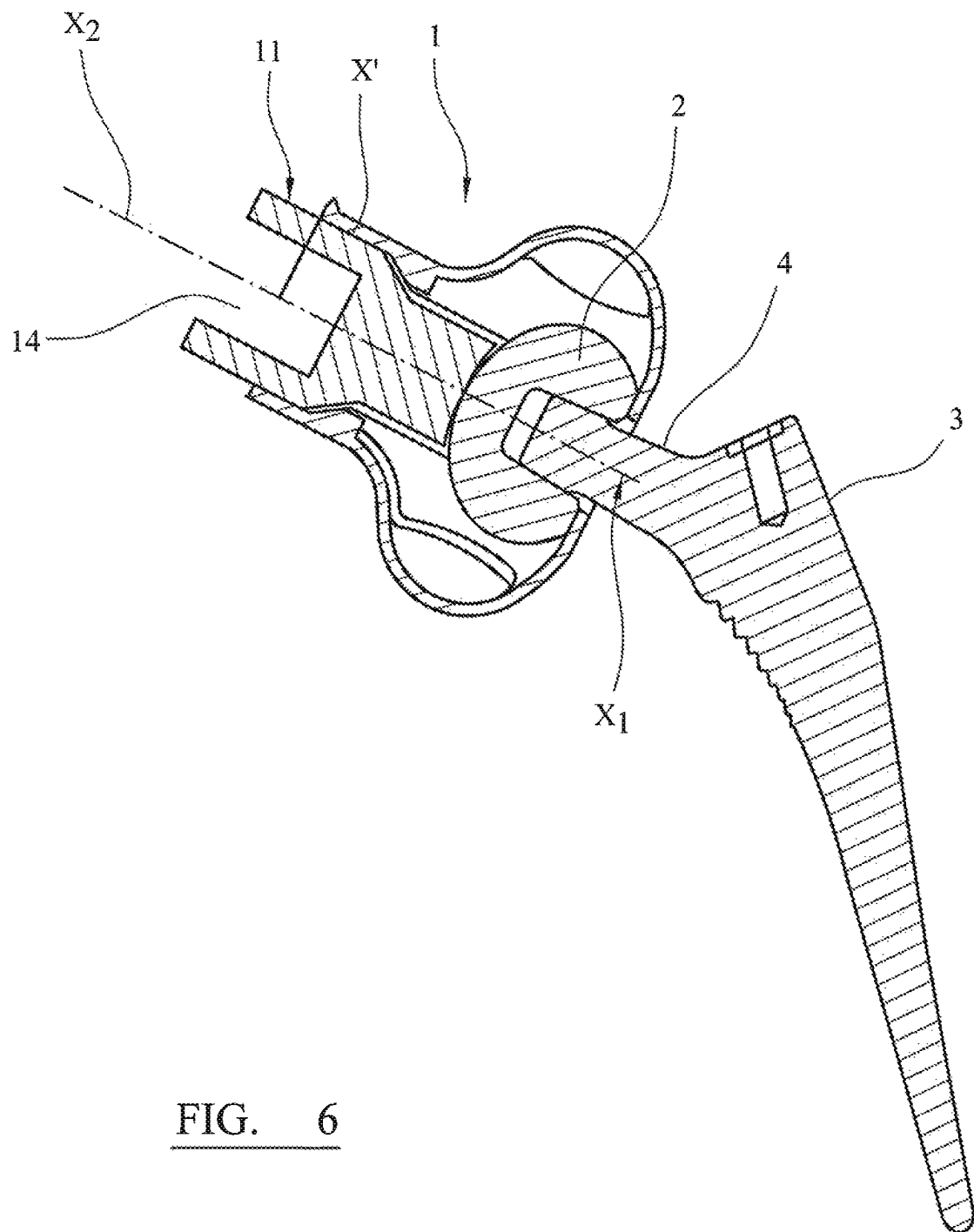


FIG. 6

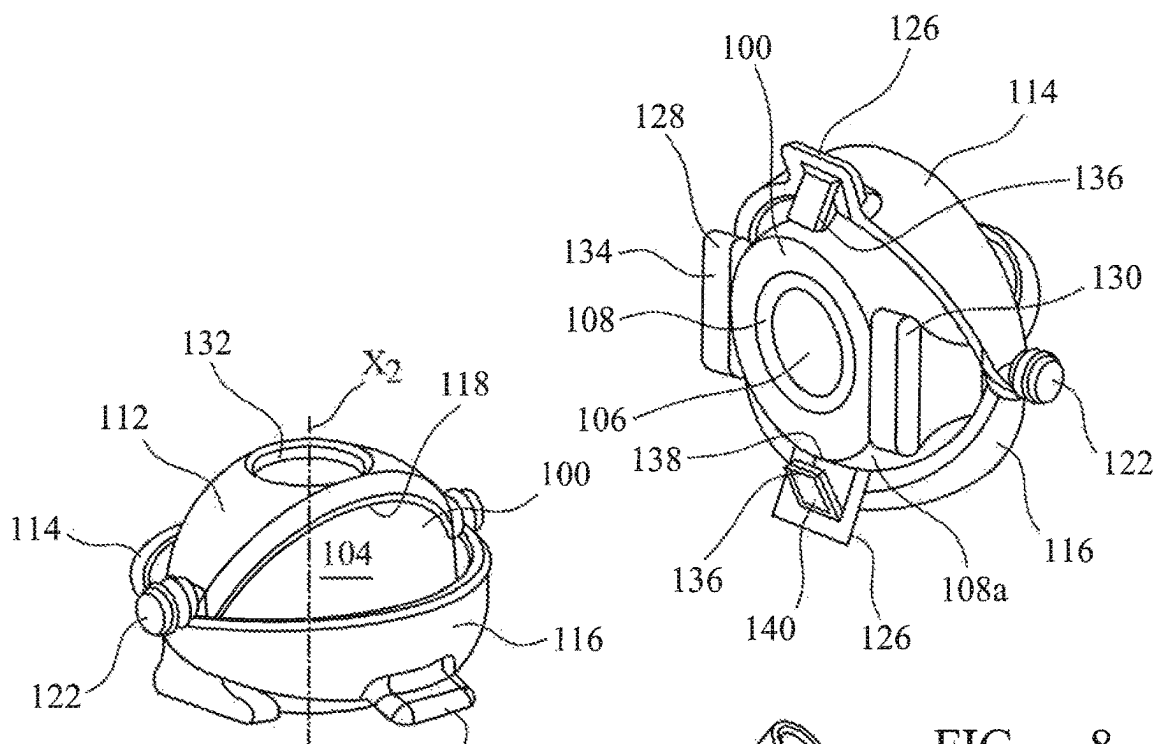


FIG. 7

FIG. 8

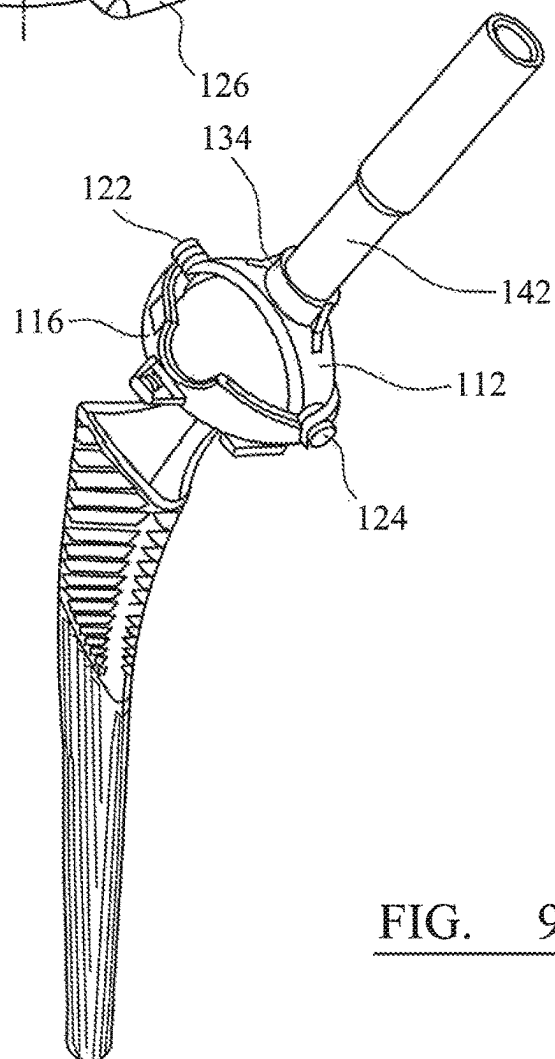


FIG. 9

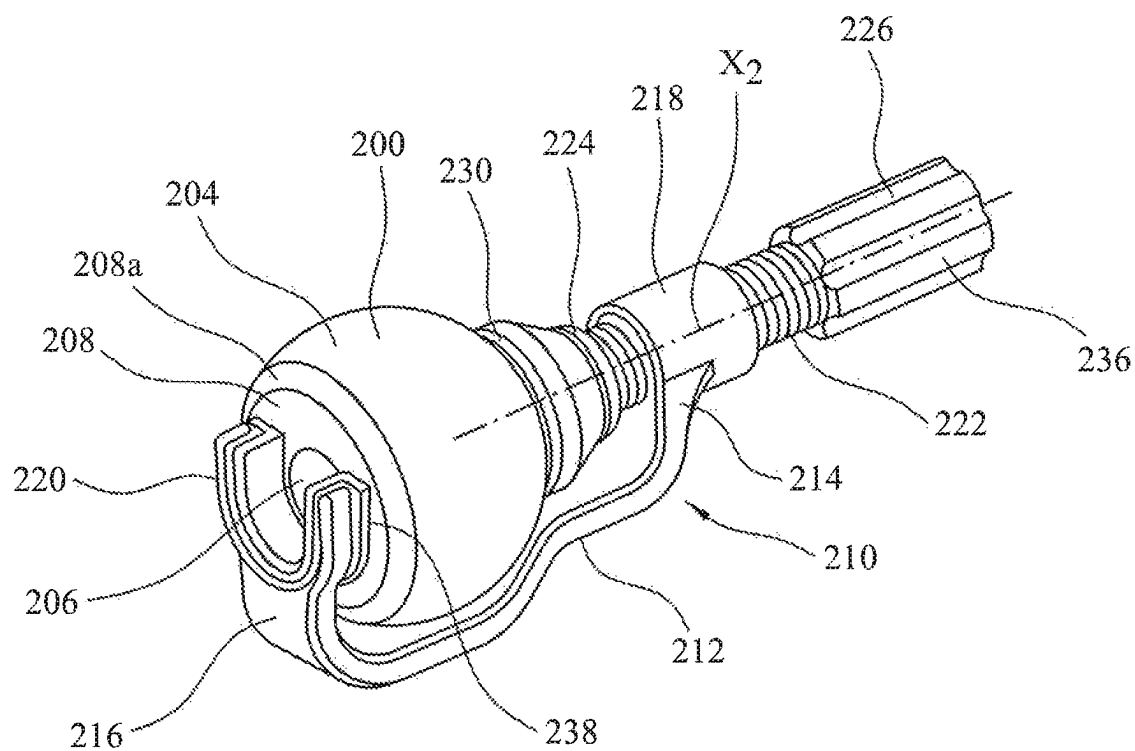


FIG. 10

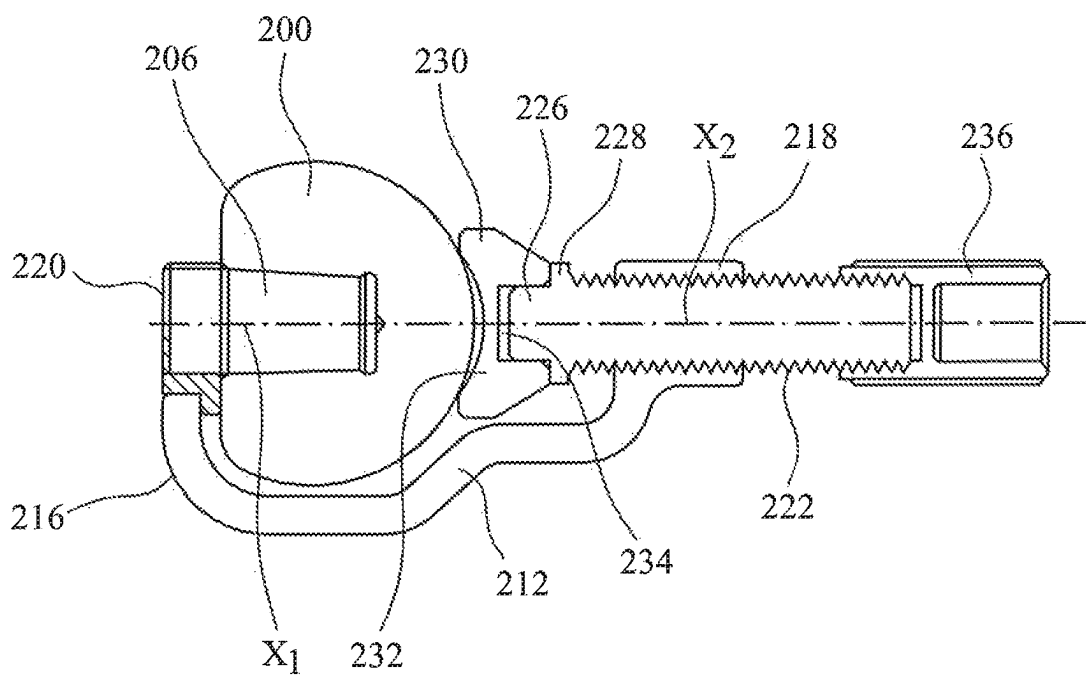


FIG. 11

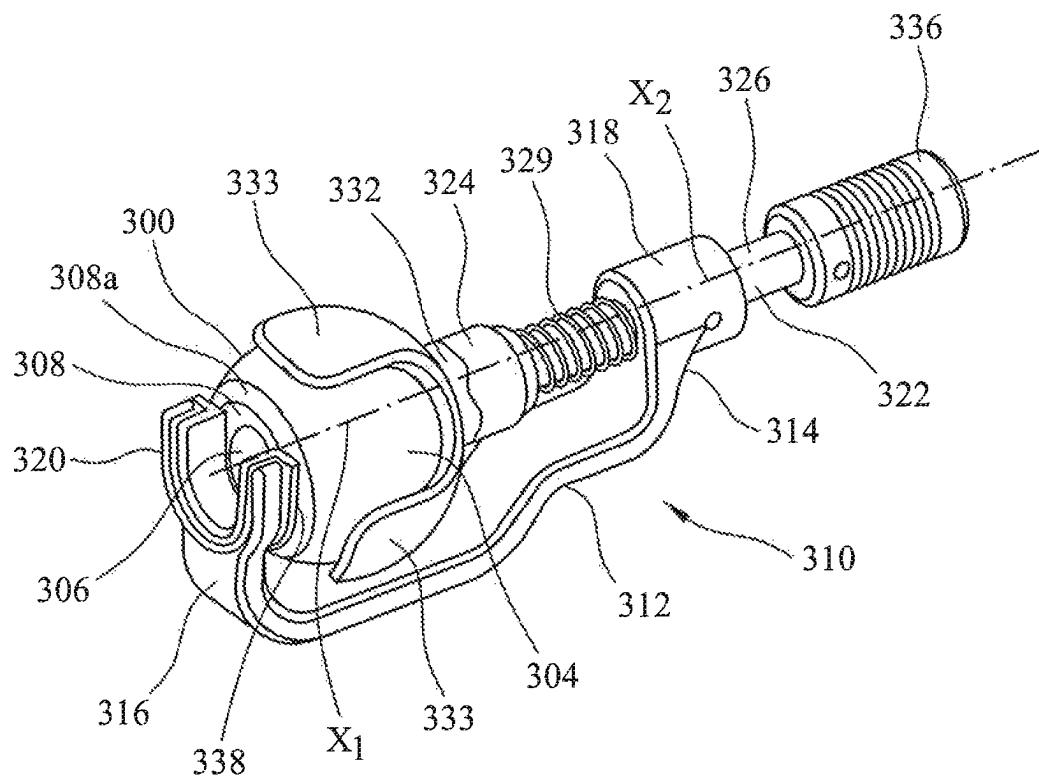


FIG. 12

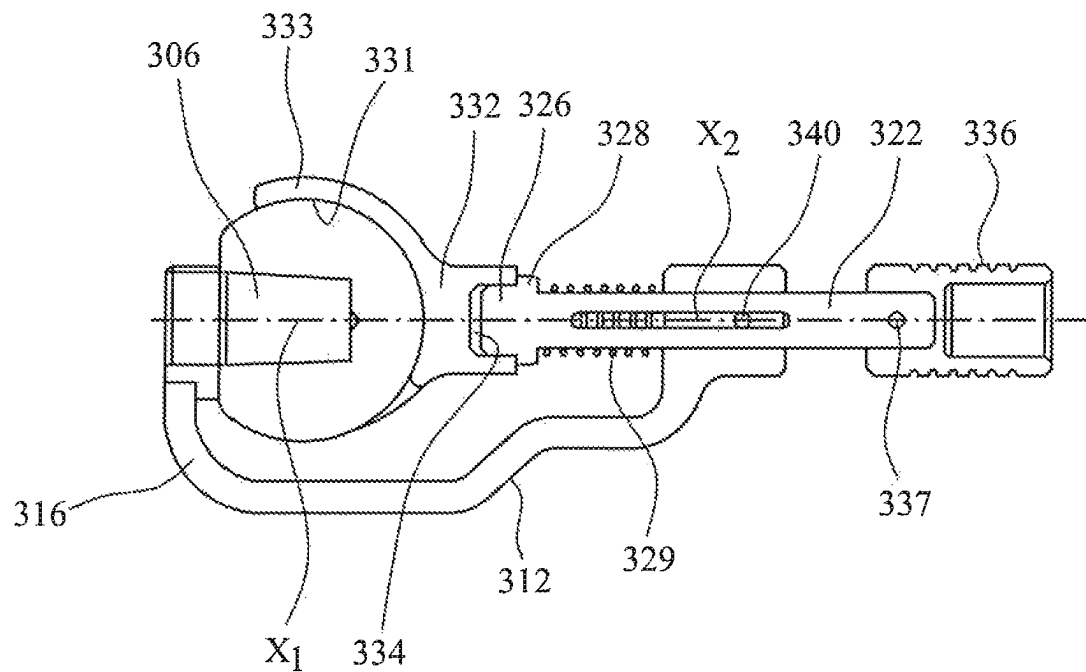


FIG. 13

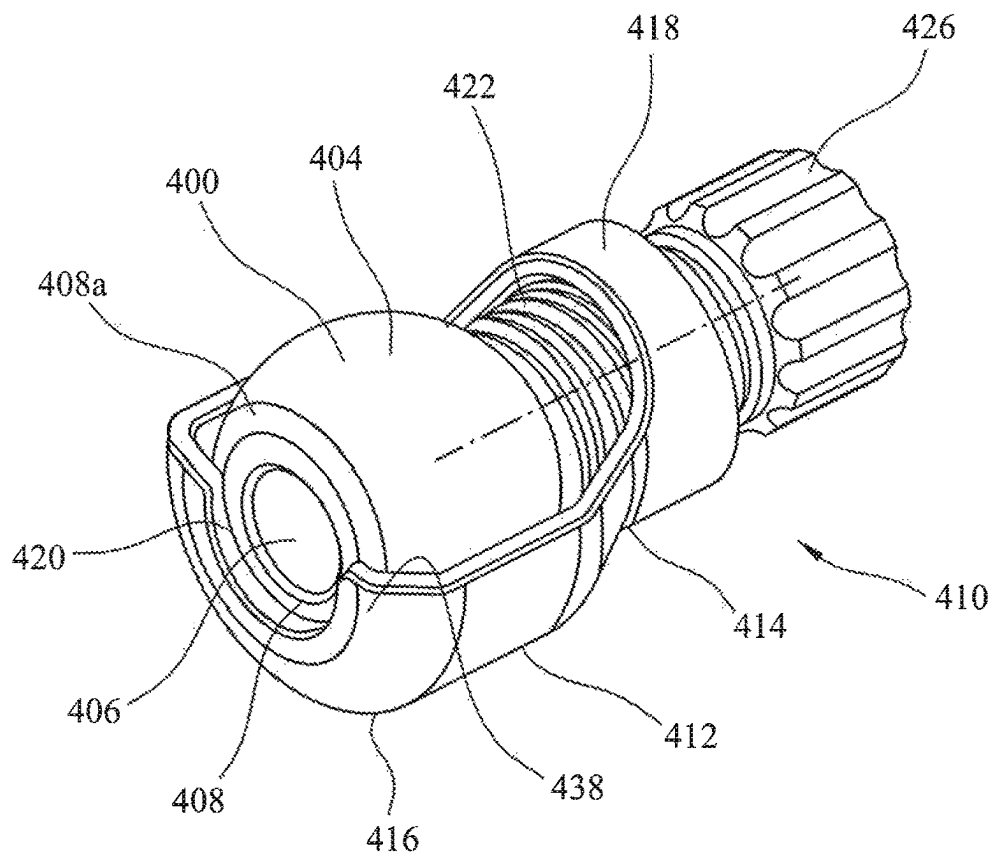


FIG. 14

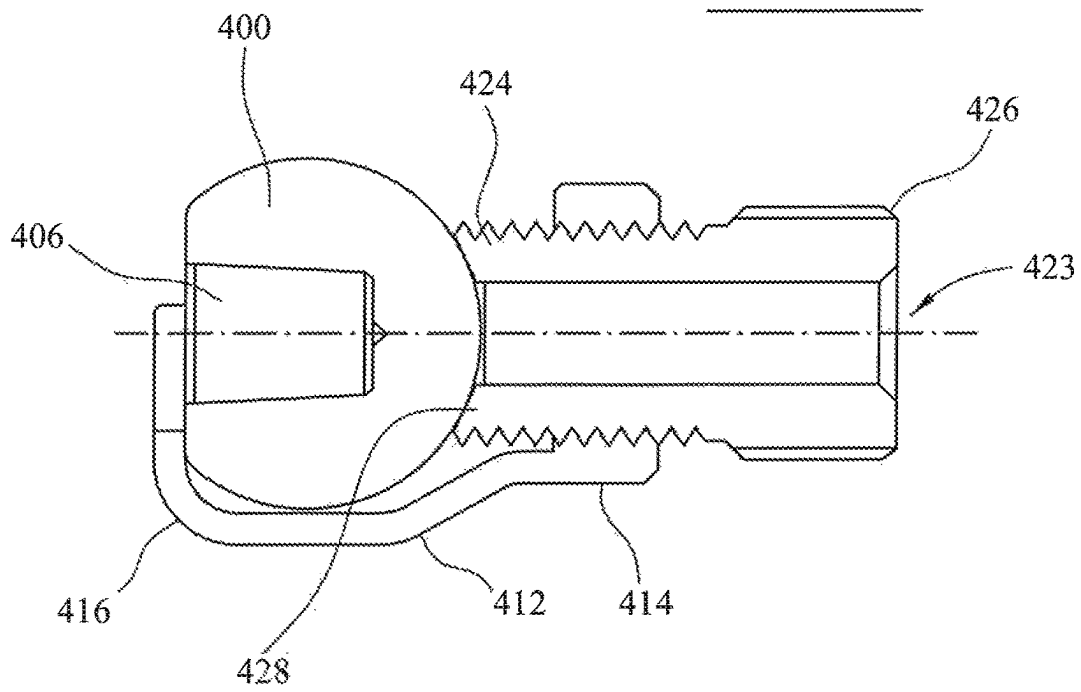


FIG. 15

FIG. 16a

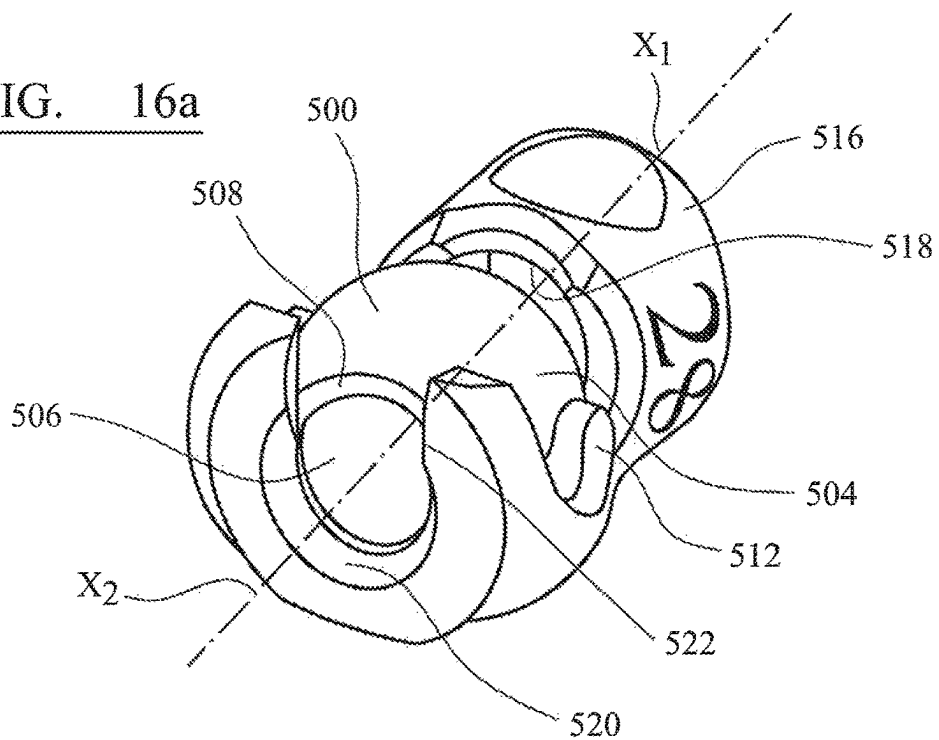


FIG. 16b

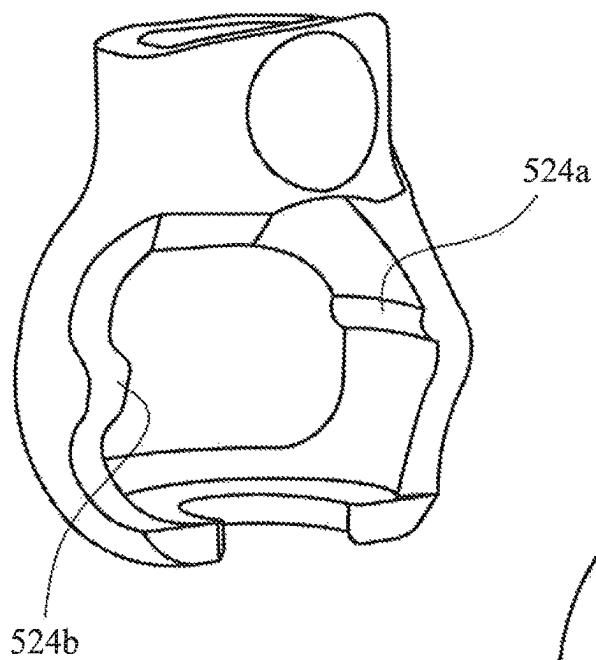
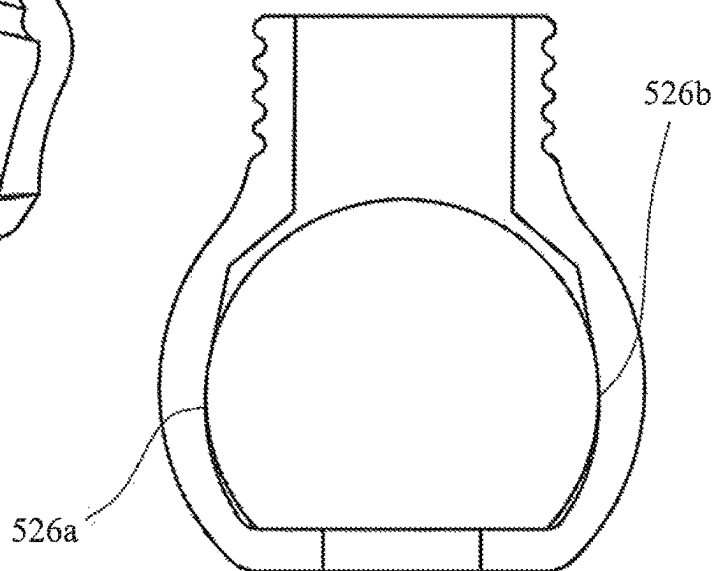
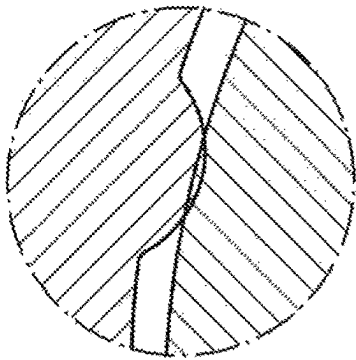


FIG. 16c





Detail G

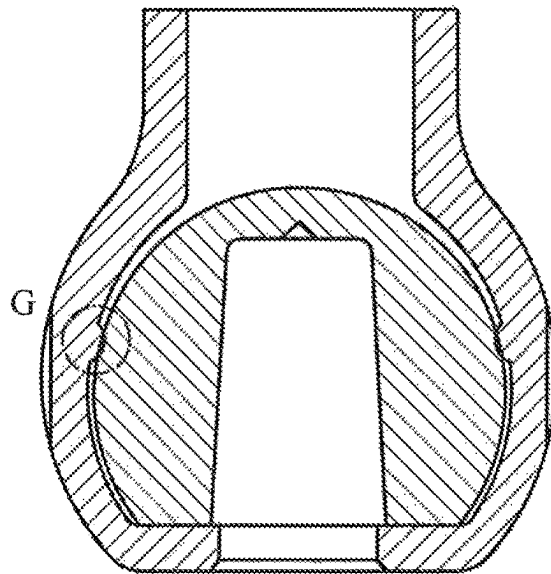
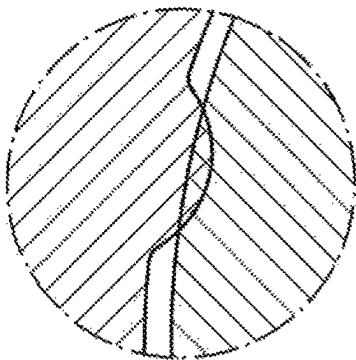


FIG. 17a



Detail G

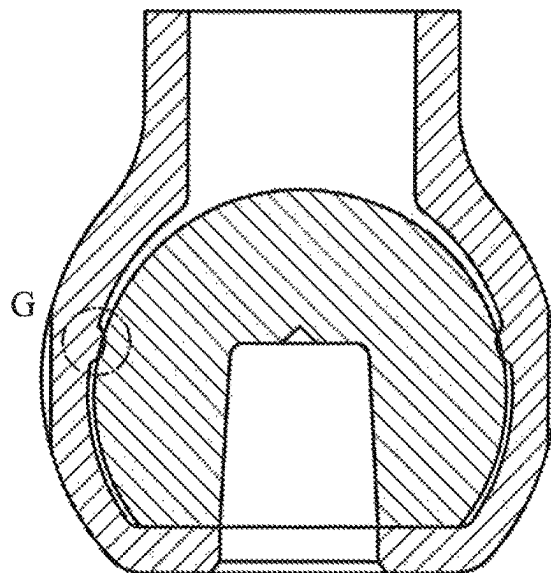
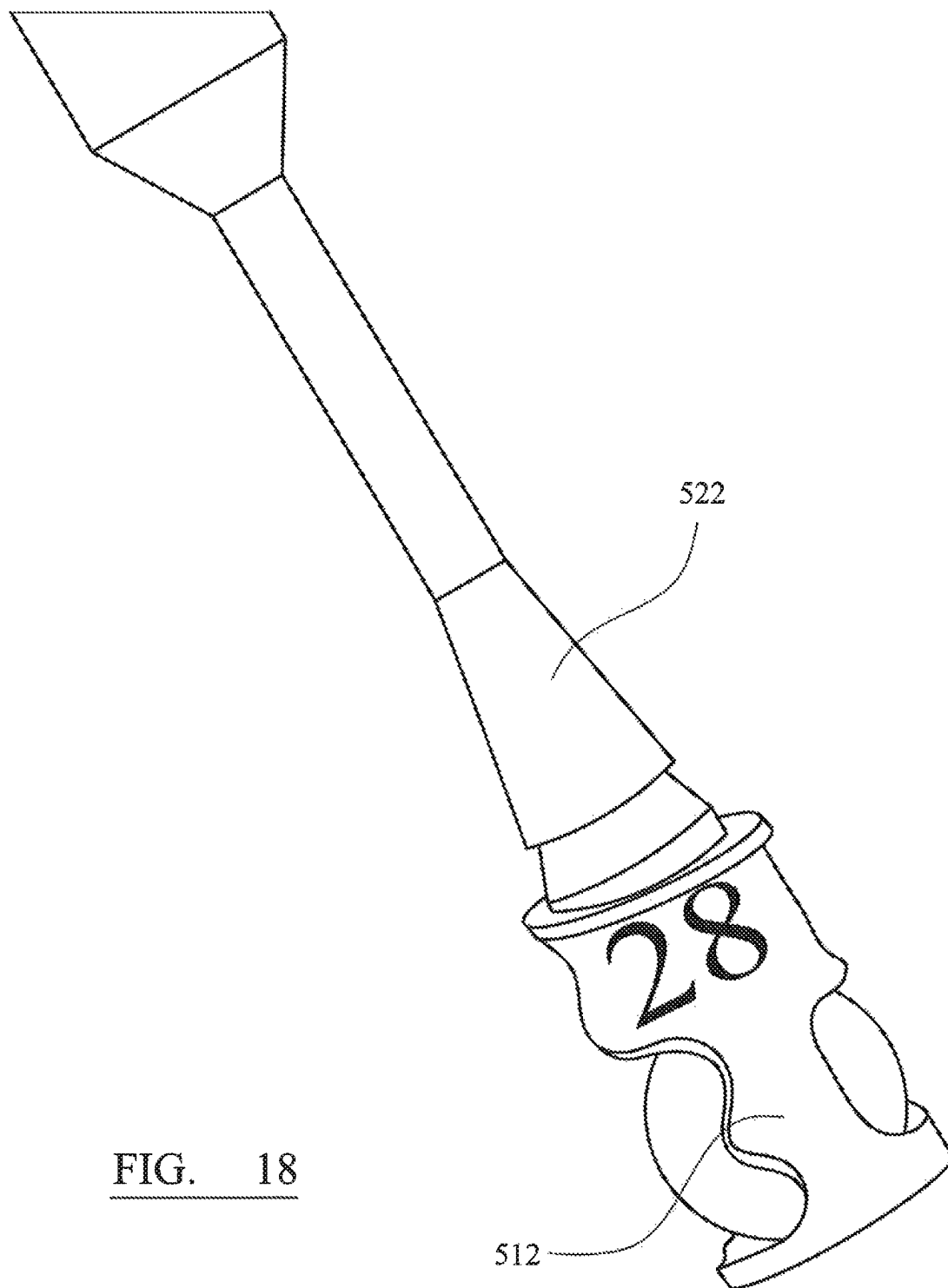


FIG. 17b



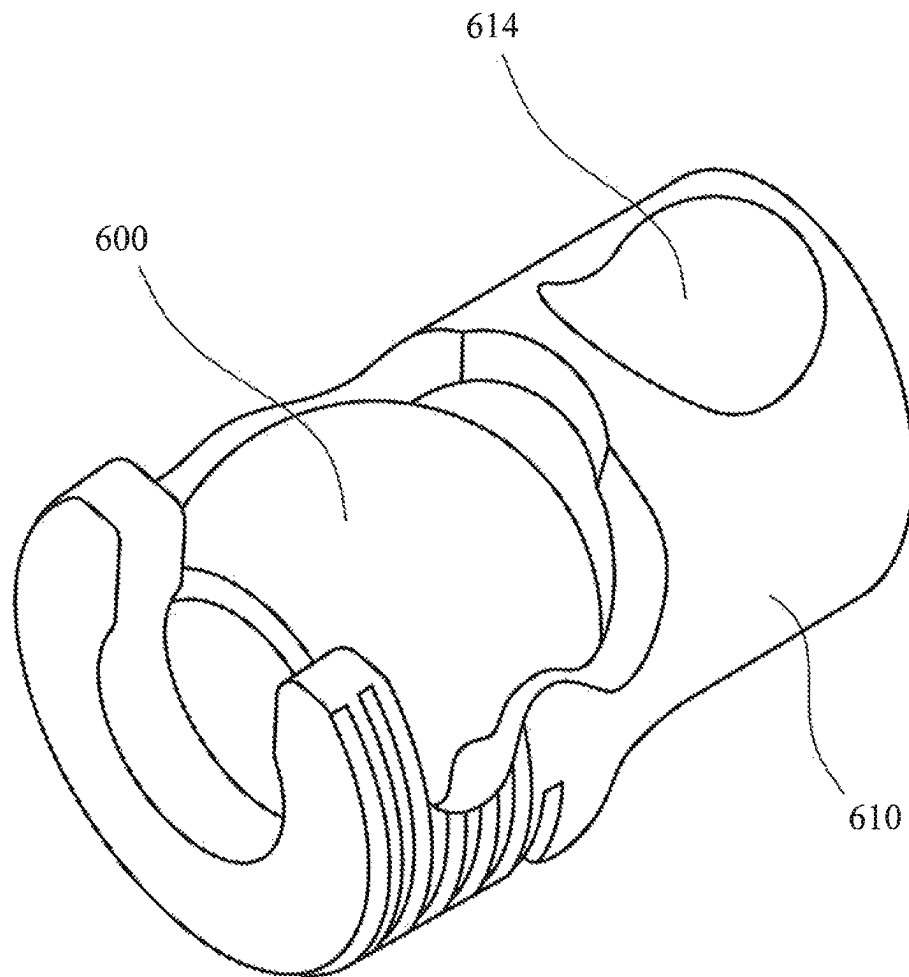
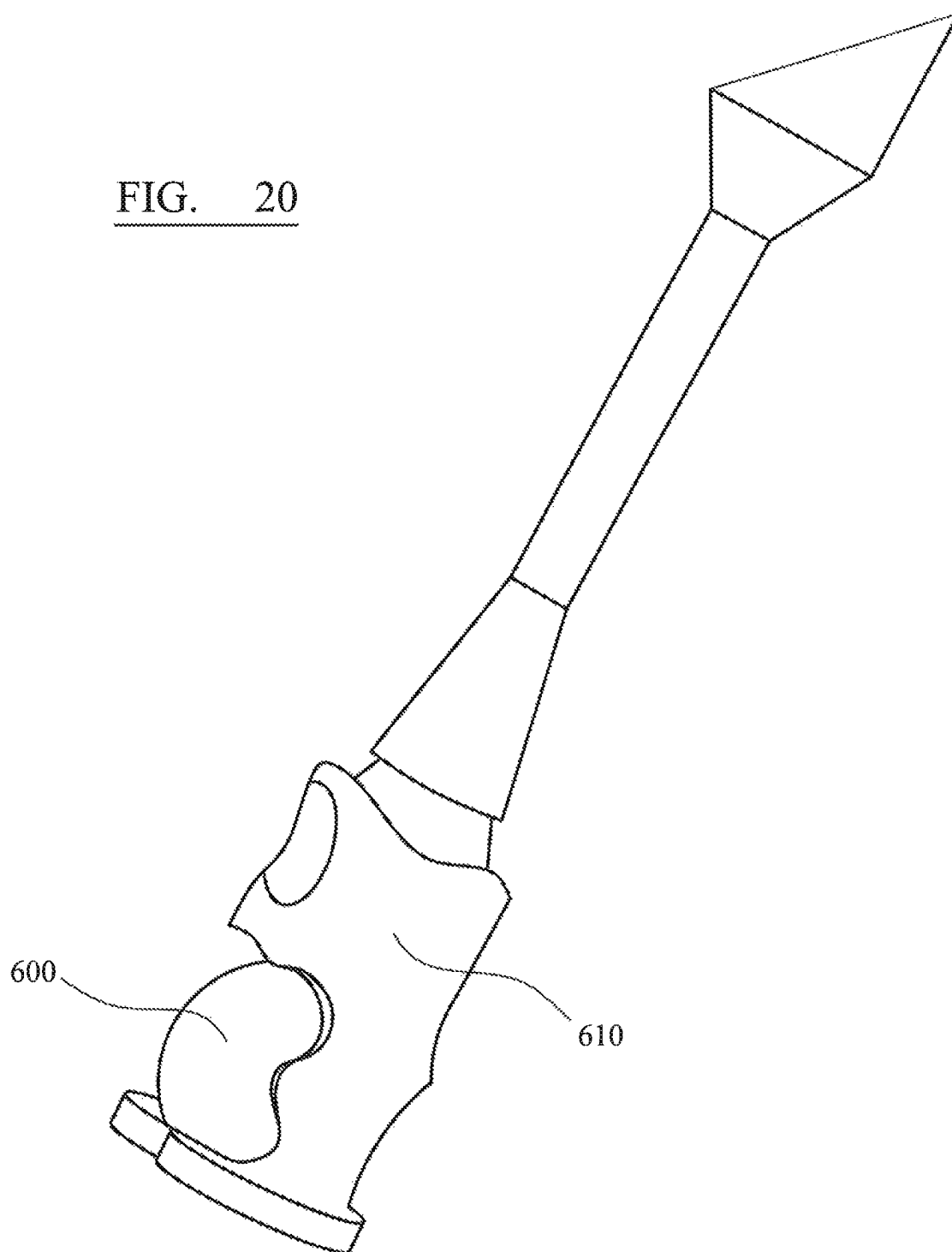


FIG. 19

FIG. 20

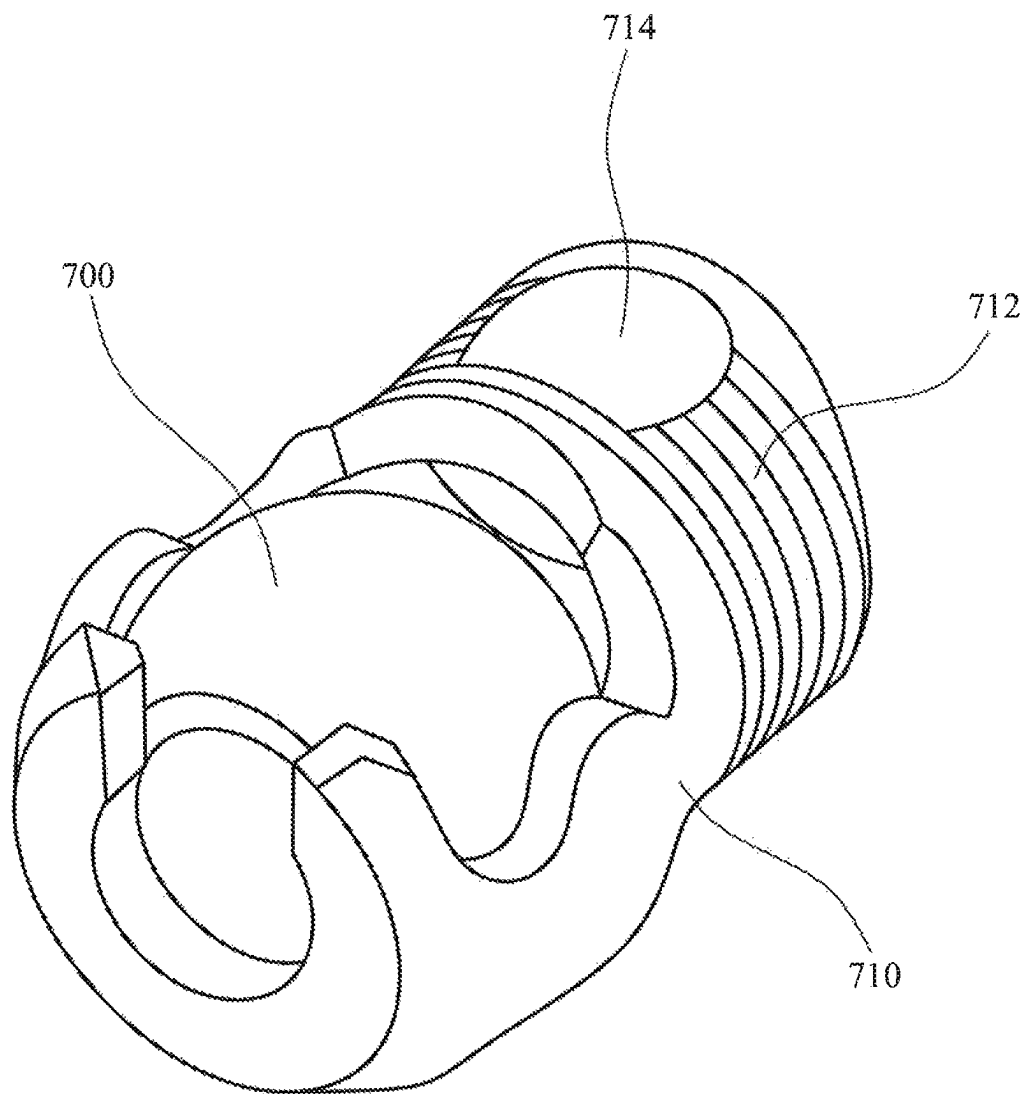


FIG. 21

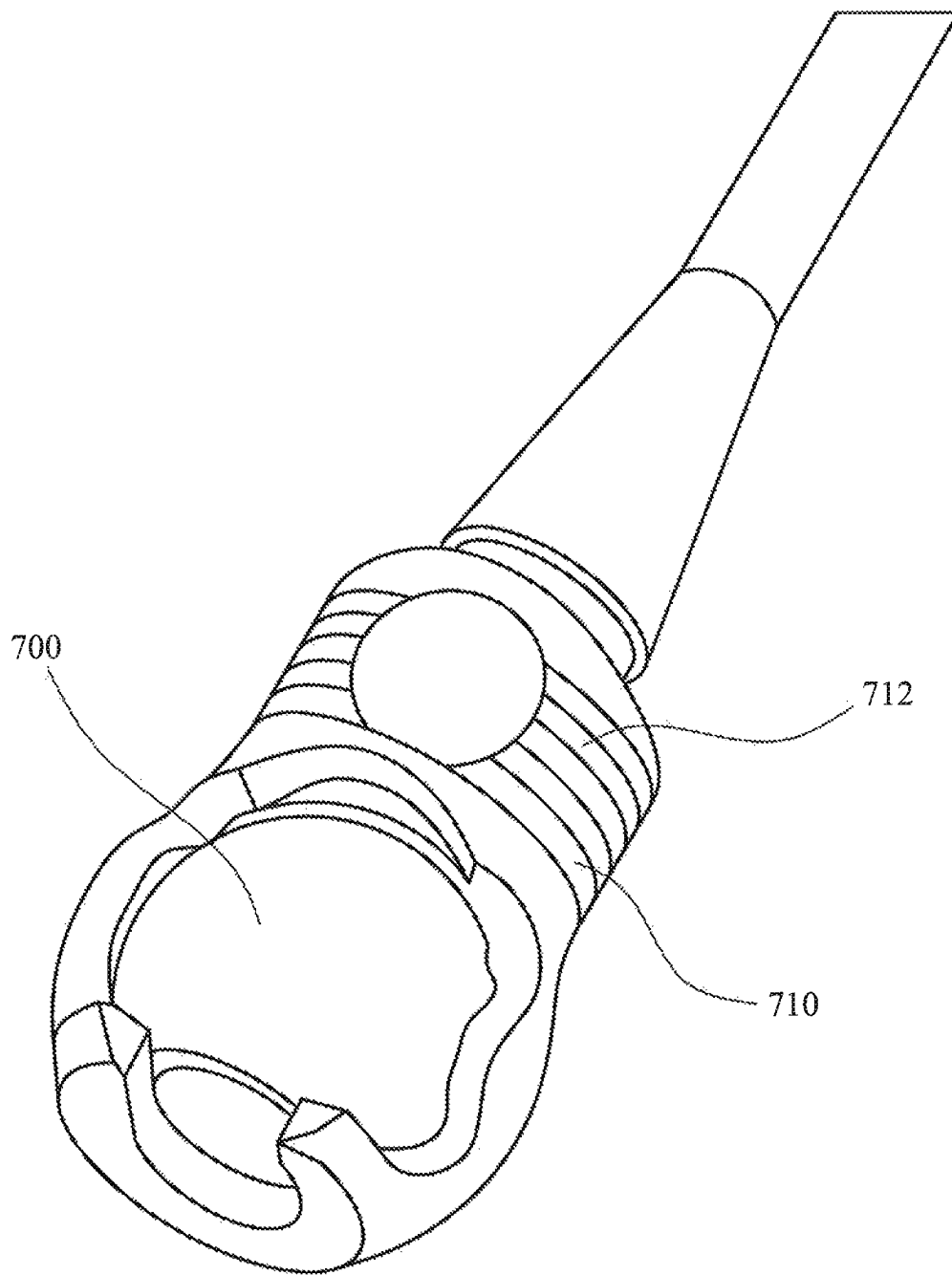


FIG. 22

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ALIGNMENT GUIDE

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

This application is a Continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/751,911 filed on Feb. 12, 2018, now pending, which is a 371 U.S. National Phase Application of PCT/EP2016/069064 filed on Aug. 10, 2016, which claims priority from Great Britain Application No. 1514727.5, filed Aug. 19, 2015 and Great Britain Application No. 1612399.4, filed Jul. 18, 2016, the entire disclosures of which are hereby incorporated in their entireties.

BACKGROUND TO THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

This invention relates an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part of a joint prosthesis component and alignment guide.

Description of the Related Art

Many orthopaedic joint prosthesis components are modular. A modular construction allows components to be assembled to meet particular requirements, for example to take account of anatomical variations between patients or surgeon preference. Examples of modular orthopaedic joint prosthesis components include femoral components of hip joint prostheses and humeral components of shoulder joint prostheses. Each of these comprises a stem part which is fitted in the intramedullary cavity of the bone (femur or humerus) and a head part. The head part has a bearing surface for articulation with a corresponding joint surface which can be provided by a mating joint prosthesis component (an acetabular component or a glenoid component) or by the patient's natural tissue. The head part has an assembly surface opposite to the bearing surface where the head part is connected to the stem part.

It is common to fasten modular parts of a joint prosthesis component to one another by means of a self-locking taper in which a tapered spigot (a term used to refer to a short projection on one component which fits into a bore in another component, in order to fasten the components together) on one part is received in a correspondingly tapered bore in the other part. An example of such a self-locking taper is a Morse taper in which the angle between the tapered surface of each of the spigot and the bore and the longitudinal axis of the spigot and the bore (when the part is viewed in cross-section) is about 1.4° to about 1.5°.

The security of a joint between two taper locked parts depends on the force that is applied to the parts when they are assembled. Sufficient force should be applied to ensure proper engagement of the surfaces of the spigot and the bore. However, it can sometimes be important to ensure that the applied force does not exceed a maximum limit, for example to avoid damage to a patient's bone tissue if the parts are being assembled with one implanted in the patient's bone, or to avoid damage to the parts of the component.

EP-A-1707160 discloses a device for applying an assembly force to parts of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis component. The device includes a hollow housing and an impacting rod which extends from the housing with a tip for contacting one of the parts of the prosthesis component. The housing contains a piston which can slide in the housing. A

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spring is located between an end of the piston and a closed end of the housing. Use of the device involves compressing the spring by forcing the piston towards the closed end of the housing and then releasing the piston so that it can slide within the housing, acted on by the spring as it relaxes.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The present invention provides an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly that includes an alignment guide which can engage an assembly surface of the head part of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis, opposite its bearing surface, so that an assembly force is applied to the parts of the prosthesis component can be directed along a first axis defined by the bore in the head part through use of the assembly surface as a reference for the alignment guide.

The invention therefore provides an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which comprises:

- a. a head part of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis component, which has a spherical bearing surface for articulation with a corresponding joint surface, and an assembly surface having a first bore formed in it for receiving a spigot on another part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis, said bore having a first axis that extends perpendicular to the assembly surface, and in which there is a discontinuity at an interface between the bearing surface and the assembly surface, the said assembly surface being arranged on a plane which is parallel to, or contains, a plane which is defined by the opening to the bore in the head part when the head part is viewed from one side in cross-section, and
- b. an alignment guide comprising an axial portion and an arm extending from the axial portion, the arm including a distal portion and a proximal portion, the distal portion being configured to engage the assembly surface of the head part, the axial portion defining a second axis and being arranged to engage the bearing surface of the head part, directly or indirectly, when the head part is mounted within the guide, with the second axis coincident with the first axis, such when an impaction force is applied along the second axis the force is directed along the first axis.

The orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly of the invention can be used in a surgical procedure to implant an orthopaedic joint prosthesis component which includes a head part and another part. Frequently, the other part will be a stem part which can be fitted in the intramedullary cavity of a patient's long bone. The invention is therefore useful in a surgical procedure to implant a femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis in which the bore in the assembly surface of the head part receives a spigot on the stem part which is intended to be fitted into the intramedullary cavity of the patient's femur. The invention is also useful in a surgical procedure to implant a humeral component of a shoulder joint prosthesis in which the bore in the assembly surface of the head part receives a spigot on the stem part which is intended to be fitted into the intramedullary cavity of the patient's humerus.

The alignment guide will be dimensioned to suit the dimensions of the prosthesis head part which is to be manipulated. The transverse dimension (which will be the diameter when the head part is configured with a spherical bearing surface) of the head part of a femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis will frequently be at least about 15 mm. It could be up to about 50 mm. The transverse dimension of

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the head part of a humeral component of a shoulder joint prosthesis will frequently be at least about 25 mm. It could be up to about 60 mm.

Each of the bearing surface and the assembly surface of the head part of the prosthesis component of the joint prosthesis assembly can be cylindrically symmetrical, with the axis of the bore is coincident with the axis of symmetry of the bearing surface. The term "cylindrically symmetrical" is used to refer to a shape which is rotationally symmetrical of infinite order. However, the joint prosthesis assembly can include a head part in which one or both of the bearing surface and the assembly surface is not cylindrically symmetrical. For example, an assembly surface might be generally circular in outline with the bore in the assembly surface being offset relative to the centre of the circular outline. A bearing surface might be defined by the surface of part of a sphere. However, a bearing surface might be curved (convex or concave) but not necessarily part spherical.

The bearing surface on the head part can be convex. This will generally be the case when the prosthesis component is a femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis. It will also generally be the case when the prosthesis component is a humeral component of an anatomic shoulder joint prosthesis.

The bearing surface on the head part can be concave. This will generally be the case when the prosthesis component is a humeral component of a reverse shoulder joint prosthesis.

The axis which is defined by the bore in the head part extends perpendicular to the assembly surface. The assembly surface is at one end of the axis and the centre of the bearing surface is at the opposite end of the axis. The assembly surface surrounds the bore. The assembly surface will generally be contained in a plane which is perpendicular to the axis defined by the bore in the head part. The assembly surface is arranged on a plane which is parallel to and/or contains the opening to the bore in the head part. The assembly surface can be shaped as a narrow ridge. The assembly surface can be provided in the form of one or more generally flat portions which are defined by a straight lines when the head part is viewed in cross-section. At least one flat portion can be planar, containing or parallel to the plane of the opening to the bore in the head part. The assembly surface can include a chamfer portion extending around the head part which is inclined to the plane which is defined by the opening to the bore in the head part when the head part is viewed from one side in cross-section. The assembly surface can include a flat planar portion which lies in the plane defined by the opening to the bore in the head part, and a chamfer portion between the flat planar portion and the bearing surface of the head part. The assembly surface can include a portion which is curved when the head part is viewed from one side in cross-section. For example, the assembly surface can include a portion which is convex and/or a portion which is concave. Such portions (flat, chamfer and curved) can extend annularly around the opening to the bore in the head part.

The assembly surface will be capable of being distinguished from the adjacent bearing surface. The bearing surface itself will be free of discontinuities which might interfere with smooth articulation of the head part with a corresponding joint surface as is the case when, for example, the bearing surface is the surface of part of a sphere. It will frequently be the case that there will be a discontinuity at the interface between the bearing and assembly surfaces, for example through a change in curvature which gives rise to a discernible ridge. The bearing surface will frequently be polished to a lower surface roughness than the assembly

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surface. Appropriate surface roughness levels for the bearing surface of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis component are well established. The assembly surface might have markings on it, for example to identify the component (for example its size).

The orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly can include a part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis having a spigot which can be received in the bore in the assembly surface of the head part. An example of such a part is a stem part of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis which can be fitted at least partially into the intramedullary cavity of a patient's bone.

In the constructions of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly in which the axial portion of the alignment guide is arranged to directly contact the bearing surface of the head part, the axial portion includes a bearing surface seating member.

Optionally, the axial portion is a shaft having a distal end and a proximal end. A longitudinal axis extends between the distal end and the proximal end of the shaft. This longitudinal axis defines the second axis. The distal end of the shaft includes a bearing surface seating member configured to directly engage the bearing surface of the prosthesis component head part. The second axis extends centrally through the bearing surface seating member. An impaction force applied directly to the proximal end of the shaft is therefore aligned with the first axis that is defined by the bore in the head part.

In some constructions, the shaft includes a blind-bore extending longitudinally from the proximal end towards the distal end. The blind-bore is dimensioned to receive an impaction tool, such as an impaction rod (through which an impaction force can be applied to the prosthesis component head part). The impaction rod has a longitudinal axis. When the impaction rod is received within the blind bore the longitudinal axis of the impaction rod is coincident with the second axis. An impaction force can be applied to head part of the prosthesis component by applying an impaction force to the proximal end of the impaction rod. An impaction force applied indirectly to the shaft in this manner is therefore aligned with the first axis that is defined by the bore in the head part.

Optionally, the axial portion is a hemi-spherical hub having a convex outer surface and a concave inner surface. The convex outer surface has a pole. An axis extends through the pole. This pole axis defines the second axis: The second axis is coincident with the first axis as defined by the bore in the head part. The concave inner surface defines a space in which a head part can be received and is configured to directly engage the bearing surface of the prosthesis component head part. An impaction rod (through which an impaction force can be applied to the prosthesis component head part) is connectable to the hub at the pole. The impaction rod has a longitudinal axis. When the impaction rod is connected to the hub at the pole, the longitudinal axis of the impaction rod is coincident with the second axis. An impaction force applied directly to the impaction rod is therefore aligned with the first axis that is defined by the bore in the head part.

The impaction rod may be connected to the hub via a socket located at the pole. The socket may be dimensioned to receive the impaction rod. In some other constructions, a sleeve can be received within the socket. The sleeve has a longitudinal axis that is coincident with the second axis. An impaction rod can extend through the sleeve component and is a sliding fit therein. The longitudinal axis of the impaction rod is also aligned with the second axis. The distal end of the impaction rod can form at least part of the bearing surface

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seating member. An impaction force applied via an impaction rod in this manner is therefore aligned with the first axis that is defined by the bore in the head part.

In other constructions of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly in which the axial portion of the alignment guide is arranged to indirectly contact the bearing surface of the head part, the bearing surface seating member is provided on a different component of the assembly from the axial portion.

Optionally, the axial portion is a sleeve having a through bore. The sleeve has a proximal end and a distal end. A longitudinal axis extends between the distal end and the proximal end of the sleeve. This longitudinal axis defines the second axis.

A shaft is received in a sliding tight fit within the through bore of the sleeve. The shaft has a proximal end and a distal end. A longitudinal axis extends between the distal end and the proximal end of the shaft. This shaft axis is aligned with the second axis, as defined by the sleeve. The distal end of the shaft is configured as a bearing surface seating member and contacts the bearing surface of the head part when the head part is mounted within the guide.

In some constructions the shaft is an impaction tool, such as an impaction rod (through which an impaction force can be applied to the prosthesis component head part). The distal end of the impaction rod is configured as a bearing surface seating member.

In some constructions, the shaft includes a blind-bore extending from the proximal end towards the distal end. The blind-bore is configured to receive an impaction tool, such as an impaction rod. An impaction force can be applied directly to the proximal end of the shaft (for example using an instrument such as a hammer or a mallet, or an instrument which generates a controlled impaction force such as the instrument disclosed in EP-A-1707160) or indirectly via an impaction rod received within the blind-bore.

Optionally, the shaft can be translated (for example, to be driven or advanced) within the sleeve along the second axis as defined by the sleeve. For example, the sleeve and the shaft can have cooperating threads so that the shaft can be advanced through the sleeve by rotating it about its axis. For example, the shaft can have an external thread which threadingly engages an internally threaded sleeve.

This ability of the shaft to be translated allows the distance between the bearing surface seating member and the assembly surface seating member to be adjusted so that the head part of the prosthesis component can be held within the alignment guide between the two seating members. This can facilitate assembly of the head and stem (or other) parts of the prosthesis component. Rotating the shaft relative to the sleeve can increase the distance between the seating members, facilitating removal of the head part from the space between the seating members. It also enables the alignment guide to be configured for use with head parts having a range of different sizes.

It will frequently be preferred that the surface of the bearing surface seating member which contacts the bearing surface of the head part of the prosthesis component is configured so that its shape is complementary to that of the bearing surface of the head part. The bearing surface of the head part can then be a nesting fit with the contact surface of the bearing surface seating member. For example, when the bearing surface of the head part is convex, it can be appropriate for the surface of the bearing surface seating member which contacts the bearing surface to be concave. When the bearing surface of the head part is concave, it can

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be appropriate for the surface of the bearing surface seating member which contacts the bearing surface to be convex.

The surface of the bearing surface seating member which contacts the bearing surface of the head part of the prosthesis component should be provided by a material and finished in such a way that the risk of damage (for example, by scratching) to the bearing surface of the head part is minimised. The contact surface could be provided by a material which is softer than the material of the bearing surface. Suitable materials are known from their use in instruments which are used to contact a bearing surface of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis when assembling or implanting it. Examples of suitable materials include low and high density polyethylenes, certain silicone elastomers, and certain poly (phenyl sulphones) (such as the material sold under the trade mark Radel).

The bearing surface seating member can be configured so that it is engaged by the head part of the prosthesis component with a press fit. This can be achieved by providing the bearing surface seating member with opposing portions which extend beyond the widest point on the head part. For example, the bearing surface seating member can be made from a resiliently deformable flexible material in the form of a concave recess whose wall is required to flex outwardly in order to insert a head part into the recess. The resiliently deformable characteristics of the material of the bearing surface seating member can mean that the seating member springs back once a head part has been positioned within the alignment guide to grip the head part.

The bearing surface seating member can have a plurality of radially extending fingers (for example at least two fingers, or at least three fingers) which are shaped to fit closely against the bearing surface of the head part. The fingers can help to locate the head part centrally relative to the axial portion through which an impaction force is applied to the head part, and to position it so that it is properly aligned with the second axis as defined by the axial portion. Optionally, the fingers can be sufficiently long to extend beyond the widest point of the head part. The widest point might be the equator in the case of the head part of a femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis, or it might be the interface between the bearing and assembly surfaces of a humeral component of a shoulder joint prosthesis. It can then be preferred that the fingers are made from a resiliently flexible material. The fingers can then be help to retain the head part of the prosthesis component within the space between the bearing surface and assembly surface seating members.

Radially extending fingers can extend radially from a point which lies on the axis defined by the bore in the head part. Radially extending fingers can extend radially from a connection with the axial portion through which an impaction force is applied to the head part.

It can be convenient for the bearing surface seating member to be capable of being removably connectable to the component of the alignment guide on which it is provided. This allows a bearing surface seating member to be replaced, for example in order to select one which is adapted for use with a different head part, or because a bearing surface seating member is damaged. The components might be connected to one another by means of mating threads. For example, in constructions in which the bearing surface seating member is provided at the distal end of a shaft, the end of the shaft could have an external thread and the bearing surface seating member can have a bore formed in it with an internal thread.

The arm which extends from the axial portion of the alignment guide defines a space around at least part of the periphery of the head part of the joint prosthesis.

The alignment guide can include more than one arm, for example at least two arms, or at least three arms, or at least four arms. Optionally, there can be spaces between neighbouring arms which allow a head part mounted within the alignment guide to be viewed and inspected.

Optionally, the at least one arm is capable of being pivoted outwardly to allow access for the head part to be mounted within the alignment guide. The at least one arm can be pivotally connected to the axial portion at or towards one end. The at least one arm can be pivoted outwardly to allow access for the head part to be mounted within the alignment guide. The at least one arm can then be pivoted inwardly to position the assembly surface seating member in contact with the assembly surface of the head part.

An alignment guide which has at least one pivoting arm can be used with head parts which have different sizes.

Optionally, the axial portion includes first and second arms which are connected to the axial portion at its widest point so that they can be pivoted relative to the axial portion between a retracted position which allows a head part to be located within the said space and a deployed position in which a head part position in the said space is retained therein.

When the alignment guide includes first and second pivotably mounted arms, a shaft which translates relative to the axial portion of the alignment guide can have a camming surface which engages respective camming surfaces on internal surfaces of the arms, causing the arms to be pivotably displaced outwardly when the shaft is translated in a distal direction. The camming surface on the shaft can be provided by the surface of a portion of the shaft which is flared outwardly. This can act on an appropriately located portion of the internal surface of each of the arms. For example, the camming surface in each of the arms can be provided by an inwardly protruding tab on the internal surfaces of the arms. The outward displacement of the camming surfaces can disengage the distal portion of each arm from the assembly surface of the head part as the head part and the stem or other part of the prosthesis component are assembled.

An alignment guide which has two or more pivoting arms can be engaged with a head part and then used to move or otherwise manipulate the head part. This can be particularly useful when the head part is being manipulated during preparatory steps prior to a surgical procedure. For example, the alignment guide can be engaged with a head part which is presented in its packaging, and then used to remove the head part from the packaging. The alignment guide can be used to position the head part on a spigot on a stem part. These steps can be performed without any need to touch the head part. This can help to preserve a polished finish on the bearing surface of the head part.

The at least one arm should have sufficient rigidity to ensure that it is not deformed unacceptably when in use.

The at least one arm can have openings which allow the head part to be inspected when it is mounted within the alignment guide. The openings also reduce the weight of the alignment guide.

The distal portion of the arm or arms functions as an assembly surface seating member. Hereinafter the distal portion of the arm is interchangeably referred to as an "assembly surface seating member".

Optionally, the assembly surface seating member can be provided by an in-turned lip at or near the end of the arm.

The assembly surface seating member can include one or more surface features which engage positively with the assembly surface of a head part. This can ensure that the head part and the assembly surface seating member can be assembled with a single stable position relative to one another. The head part can be held within the alignment guide as a result of engagement of the surface features with the assembly surface against transverse movement. The bore in the assembly surface of the head part is aligned with the second axis defined by the axial portion when the surface features on the assembly surface are engaged positively with the assembly surface of a head part. This ensures that the second axis (as defined by the axial portion) along which force is applied to the head part of the prosthesis component is aligned with the first axis (as defined by the bore). An example of a surface feature is a recess which can engage the head part around at least part of the external periphery of the assembly surface. The recess can be continuous. The recess could be defined by one or more protrusions which engage the assembly surface of the head part at spaced apart points around the head part. A surface feature could include one or more protrusions which fit into corresponding detents formed in the assembly surface.

The assembly surface seating member can be shaped so that it restricts transverse movement of the head part of the prosthesis component. For example, the assembly surface seating member can engage an edge of the assembly surface of the head part. The edge of the assembly surface can be an outside edge. The outside edge of the assembly surface might be at or close to an outside edge of the head part when the head part is shallow (for example when the depth of the head part is less than half of its width, as can be the case with the humeral component of a shoulder prosthesis). The outside edge of the assembly surface might be at the interface between the rounded bearing surface of the head part and the assembly surface. The assembly surface might have a chamfer portion which is located between the rounded bearing surface and the bore. The outside edge of the assembly surface might be at the interface between the rounded bearing surface of the head part and the chamfer portion of the assembly surface. The lip might engage other features on the assembly surface. For example, the assembly might make use of one or more protrusions on one of the assembly surface seating member and the assembly surface of the head part and one or more detents on the other of the assembly surface seating member and the assembly surface.

The assembly surface seating member can include a series of surface features which can engage with the assembly surfaces of a plurality of distinct head parts having different sizes. For example, an assembly surface seating member can be provided with a series of recesses, each of which is configured to engage a respective head part. For example, when the assembly surfaces on the head parts are circular in outline, the recesses can be concentric, with each one shaped as part or the whole of a circle. The head part can be restrained against translation relative to the assembly surface seating member when it is engaged with its respective recess.

It is also envisaged that the surface of the assembly surface seating member might be free of interruptions so that the assembly surface of a head part can translate across the surface of the assembly surface seating member. The surface could be essentially planar. The surface might be profiled so as to promote centring of the head part. For example, it might be concave with a centre which is aligned with the centre of the bore in a head part when properly positioned on the surface. The head part can be located appropriately on

the assembly surface seating member as a result of engagement between the bearing surface seating member and the bearing surface, causing the assembly surface to translate on the surface of the assembly surface seating member until it is properly centred. An alignment guide having these features might accommodate a plurality head parts having different sizes. For example, head parts with different sizes, and therefore with differently sized assembly surfaces, can contact different regions of the second seating member. The different regions can be arranged concentrically when the head parts are circular.

It can be preferred that the assembly surface seating member engages the assembly surface of the head part at least three spaced apart points. The assembly surface seating member can be provided in multiple sections on respective arms which extend separately from the axial portion, with each section of the assembly surface seating member engaging the assembly surface at a respective point around the assembly surface. For example, when the alignment guide provides an in-turned lip at the distal end of a narrow arm, it can be preferred that there are at least three such arms whose in-turned lips can engage the assembly surface of the head part at three spaced apart points around the assembly surface. Sections of the assembly surface seating member can be provided on two arms where each section is approximately U-shaped. The two arms can be positioned next to one another so that the sections of the assembly surface seating member together extend almost around the entire assembly surface of the head part apart possibly from small breaks at the gaps between the arms. The assembly surface seating member can have a slot formed in it which is open to one side so that it is approximately U-shaped. These arrangements can help to ensure that the head part of the prosthesis component is located positively relative to the alignment guide.

In some constructions, the alignment guide can include a deployable retainer which, when deployed, can help to retain the head part within the space between the bearing surface seating member and the assembly surface seating member. The retainer can be deployed to close at least partially the opening through which the head part is inserted into the space between the seating members. The retainer can slide between deployed and retracted positions. When the space between the seating members is shaped to receive a generally spherical head part, the retainer can be shaped so as to follow a generally spherical contour. A retainer which can follow a generally spherical contour can be retracted to a position in which it is in a surface-to-surface facing relationship with an adjacent wall portion of the alignment guide.

An alignment guide can include a deployable retainer in addition to a bearing surface seating member which is formed from a resiliently deformable material and engages the head part of the prosthesis component with a press fit.

In some constructions, the alignment guide can have stand surfaces which enable it to be positioned on a surface while a head part is positioned within the alignment guide. For example, when an alignment guide has two or more pivoting arms with which it can be engaged with a head part and then used to move or otherwise manipulate the head part, each of the arms can have stand surfaces which enable the guide to be positioned on a flat surface with each of the stand surfaces in contact with the surface. This can be convenient during preparatory steps prior to a surgical procedure, minimising the need for a user to contact surfaces of the head part directly, and avoiding the need for the head part itself to be placed in contact with the flat surface.

It will often be preferred that some or all of the components of the alignment guide are made from a polymeric material. This has the advantage of light weight compared with components made from metals. Components made from polymeric materials can be manufactured conveniently using moulding techniques. Components made from certain polymeric materials can be less likely to damage (for example by scratching) a polished surface such as a prosthesis component bearing surface compared with components made from a metal.

The invention also provides a method of assembling an orthopaedic joint prosthesis, which comprises:

- a. providing an assembly according to the invention together with another part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis component which has a spigot which can be received in the bore in the head part,
- b. mounting the head part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis component within the alignment guide so that the distal portion of the arm is engaged with the assembly surface of the head part, and the axial portion engages, either directly or indirectly, the bearing surface of the head part,
- c. locating the spigot on the other part of the prosthesis component in the bore in the head part, and
- d. applying an impaction force to the head part through the axial portion, in which the impaction force applied to the second axis as defined by the axial portion is directed along the first axis as defined by the bore in the head part.

The invention also provides a method of implanting an orthopaedic joint prosthesis, which comprises:

- a. providing an assembly according to the invention together with another part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis component which has a spigot which can be received in the bore in the head part,
- b. mounting the head part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis component within the alignment guide so that the distal portion of the arm is engaged with the assembly surface of the head part, and the axial portion engages, either directly or indirectly, the bearing surface of the head part,
- c. locating the spigot on the other part of the prosthesis component in the bore in the head part, and
- d. applying an impaction force to the head part through the axial portion, in which the impaction force applied to the second axis as defined by the axial portion is directed along the first axis as defined by the bore in the head part.

in which the said other part of the orthopaedic joint prosthesis component is implanted in a patient's bone prior to the step of applying an impaction force.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The invention is described below by way of example with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:

FIG. 1 is a side view of a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis.

FIG. 2 is an isometric view of a head part of a femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis.

FIG. 3 is an isometric view of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and an alignment guide for use in assembling the femoral component.

FIG. 4 is an isometric view of the alignment guide shown in FIG. 3 and the head part of the femoral component, with the arms of the alignment device in an open position.

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FIG. 5 is a cross-section of the alignment guide shown in FIG. 3 with the arms in an open position;

FIG. 6 is a cross-section of the alignment guide shown in FIG. 3 together with the femoral component.

FIG. 7 is an isometric view from above of an alignment guide and the head part of a femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis.

FIG. 8 is an isometric view from below of the alignment guide and head part shown in FIG. 7.

FIG. 9 is an isometric view of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and the alignment guide shown in FIG. 7.

FIG. 10 is an isometric view of another orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and the alignment guide.

FIG. 11 is a cross-section through the assembly shown in FIG. 10.

FIG. 12 is an isometric view of another orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and the alignment guide.

FIG. 13 is a cross-section through the assembly shown in FIG. 12.

FIG. 14 is an isometric view of another orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and the alignment guide,

FIG. 15 is a cross-section through the assembly shown in FIG. 14.

FIGS. 16a to 16c show isometric views of another orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and the alignment guide.

FIGS. 17a and 17b shows cross-sectional views through the longitudinal axis of the assembly shown in FIGS. 16a and 16b.

FIG. 18 is an isometric view of the assembly shown in FIG. 16 with an impaction rod inserted into the alignment guide.

FIG. 19 is an isometric view of another orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and the alignment guide.

FIG. 20 is an isometric view of the assembly shown in FIG. 19 with an impaction rod inserted into the alignment guide.

FIG. 21 is an isometric view of another orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising a modular femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis and the alignment guide.

FIG. 22 is an isometric view of the assembly shown in FIG. 21 with an impaction rod inserted into the alignment guide.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

Referring to the drawings, FIG. 1 shows a femoral component 1 of a hip joint prosthesis which includes a head part 2 and a stem part 3. The stem part 3 is configured to be implanted in the intramedullary cavity of a patient's femur.

The head part 2 has a smooth outer bearing surface 6 which is intended to articulate with a corresponding joint surface. The corresponding joint surface will usually be provided by an acetabular component of the hip joint prosthesis. However, it might be that a head part might be intended to articulate with a corresponding joint surface provided by the patient's natural tissue. The outer bearing surface has a generally spherical shape, which is truncated to define an assembly surface 8. A tapered bore 5 is formed

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in the head part, extending inwardly from the assembly surface, perpendicular to the assembly surface. The first axis 7 of the head part extends perpendicular to the assembly surface and is defined by tapered bore 5.

The assembly surface is at one end of the axis 7 and the centre of the bearing surface is at the opposite end of the axis. The assembly surface surrounds the bore. The assembly surface is generally planar, defined by a straight line when the head part is viewed in cross-section. The flat portion extends annularly around the opening to the bore in the head part. The flat portion is planar, containing the plane of the opening to the bore in the head part.

The stem part 3 includes a tapered spigot 4. The tapered spigot on the stem part and the tapered bore in the head part are configured so that they can form a self-locking taper lock when the head and stem parts are assembled. Preferably, the angle between the tapered surface of each of the spigot and the bore and the longitudinal axis of the spigot and the bore (when the part is viewed in cross-section) is about 1.4° to about 1.5°.

FIG. 2 shows another head part of a femoral component of a hip joint prosthesis. The assembly surface includes a planar portion 8 surrounding the bore 5, which lies in a plane which is perpendicular to the axis defined by the bore. The assembly surface also includes an annular chamfer portion 8a which is located between the planar portion 8 and the bearing surface 6 of the head part. The chamfer portion extends around the head part, and which is inclined to the plane which is defined by the opening to the bore in the head part when the head part is viewed in cross-section. The assembly surface could include an annular portion which is curved, generally in a convex sense, when the head part is viewed in cross-section. When the assembly surface has a chamfer portion or a curved portion without a planar portion, there will be a narrow ridge surrounding the opening to the bore 5.

FIG. 3 shows an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes the femoral component 1 shown in FIG. 1 and an alignment guide 10 for use in assembling the stem and head parts 2, 3 of the femoral component.

The alignment guide 10 comprises an axial portion in the form of a shaft 11 and arms 16a, 16b extending therefrom. The shaft has first and second portions 12, 13 and carries an impaction tip 15 which can contact the bearing surface of a head part of a femoral prosthesis component, functioning as a bearing surface seating member. The shaft defines a second axis X2 (as shown in FIG. 5). The diameter of the first portion 12 of the shaft is greater than that of the second portion 13. A tapered portion 24 of the shaft extends between the first and second portions. In the construction shown in the drawings, the shaft 11 has a bore 14 in the first portion 12 at its free end in which the end of an impaction device can be received through which an impaction force can be applied to the impaction component. However, the shaft might be acted on directly by an impaction device such as a mallet. The surface of the impaction tip 15 is concave, to match the convex bearing surface of the head part 2 of the femoral component.

Each arm 16a, 16b includes a collar portions 18a, 18, a neck portion 19a, 19b and a head portion 20a, 20b. Each collar portion 18a, 18b comprises a pair of curved projections 29a, 29a'; 29b, 29b' which have a partially cylindrical profile and are dimensioned to fit around a portion of the exterior surface of the first portion 12 of the shaft 11. The two arms 16a, 16b are pivotally connected to one another at the collar portions 18a, 18b. The pivotal connections are achieved by providing a lug 28a, 28b on one of the curved

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projections **29a'**, **29b** of the collar portions **18a**, **18b** of the arms **16a**, **16a**, and an aperture **30a**, **30b** on the other curved projection **29a**, **29b'** of the respective collar portions **18a**, **18b** of the arms **16a**, **16a**. A lug **28a**, **28b** cooperates with a respective aperture **30a**, **30b** to define a pivot point **31a**, **31b**.

The arms **16a**, **16b** are substantially the same and have a curved, bowl-shaped, contour such that when they abut each other in a closed position, the two arms **16a**, **16b** define an internal cavity or space **17** which encloses the femoral head part **2**. This is shown in FIG. 4.

The arms **16a**, **16b** are shaped so that the neck **19** is circular in cross-section and defines a hollow cylinder with a diameter substantially similar to that of the collar **18**.

The distal portion of each of the arms **16a**, **16b**, i.e., the portion of each arm remote from the collar portions **18a**, **18b**, has an in-turned lip **22a**, **22b**. When the arms are in their closed position, the lips **22a**, **22b** form an almost continuous annular surface which faces towards the collar **18**, with just small discontinuities at the interfaces between the arms. An opening **23** is provided in the end of the alignment guide by semi-circular cut-outs **27a**, **27b** in the ends of the arms **16a**, **16b**. The opening **23** is larger than the opening of the bore **5** into the assembly surface **8** of the head part **2** so that access to the recess **5** is not obscured by the lips **22a**, **22b**.

The arms **16a**, **16b** include windows **32** in the side walls of the head portions **20a**, **20b** which reduce the weight of the alignment guide **10**. The windows also allow a user to inspect the femoral head part within the internal cavity **17**.

Each of the neck portions **19a**, **19b** includes a tab **25** with an inclined surface **26** which engages and cooperates with the inclined surface **24** of the impaction component **11** when the alignment guide **21** is in a first, unactuated position. The tabs **25** are provided internally of the neck **19** of the alignment guide **21**.

In use, the spigot **4** on the stem part **3** of the femoral component is located in the bore **5** in the head part **2** and the head and stem parts are pressed together.

The head part is then located in the space **17** while the arms **16a**, **16b** are in their open position, so that the bearing surface **6** is in contact with the impaction tip **15**. The arms are then pivoted to their closed position in which the lips **22a**, **22b** engage the assembly surface **8** on the head part **2** so that the head part is located between the impaction tip **15** and the lips **22a**, **22b**. The spigot **4** on the stem part then extends through the opening **23** provided by the semi-circular cut-outs **27a**, **27b** in the ends of the arms. The engagement of the annular surface provided by the lips **22a**, **22b** with the assembly surface determines the orientation of the head part relative to the alignment guide, in particular so that the first axis X1 defined by the bore **5** in the head part **2** is coincident with the second axis X2 which is defined by the shaft **11** of the alignment guide **10**. This ensures that when an impaction force is applied along the second axis X2 the force is directed along the first axis X1.

An impaction force is applied to the shaft **11** through an impaction rod which is inserted into the bore **14** in the end of the first portion **12** of the shaft. Alternatively, the impaction force could be applied direction to the shaft. The impaction force is transmitted through the shaft to the head part of the femoral component, which involves translation of the shaft relative to the alignment guide **21**. The translation of the shaft, with the tapered portion **24** of the shaft in contact with the tabs **25** on the internal surfaces of the neck **19** of the alignment guide **21**, causes the arms **16a**, **16b** to pivot outwardly, reducing the contact between the lips **22a**, **22b** and the assembly surface **8** of the head part.

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FIGS. 7 to 9 show an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part **100** of a femoral component such as that shown in FIG. 2 and an alignment guide **110** for use in assembling the stem and head parts of a femoral component. The head part **100** of the femoral component can be fitted to a stem part having a tapered spigot at its proximal end. The head part **100** has a bearing surface **104** and a bore **106** in an assembly surface **108**. The bore defines a first axis X1. The assembly surface can include a flat planar portion which lies in the plane defined by the opening to the bore in the head part, and a chamfer portion **108a** between the flat planar portion and the bearing surface of the head part. The chamfer portion extends around the head part which is inclined to the plane which is defined by the opening to the bore in the head part when the head part is viewed from one side in cross-section.

The alignment guide **110** comprises an axial portion in the form of a hub spar **112**. First and second arms **114**, **116** extend from the hub spar. The hub spar is curved with a concave inner surface **118** which defines a space within it. The hub spar has a socket **132** formed in it. The centre of the socket **132** defines a second axis X2. A sleeve component **134** can be provided in the socket as shown in FIG. 9. A shaft **142** can extend through the sleeve component and is a sliding fit therein. When the tool includes a sleeve component, the first and second arms can have semi-circular cut-outs so that the arms can fit snugly against the sleeve component.

Each of the arms **114**, **116** is connected to the hub spar at the first and second pivot points **122**, **124** so that each of the arms can pivot relative to the spar. Each of the arms has a tab **126** which can be engaged by a user to move the arm between its deployed position as shown in the drawings and a retracted position in which each of the arms is pivoted towards the hub spar.

The hub spar includes first and second extensions **128**, **130** beyond the pivot points **122**, **124**. Each of the extensions has a flat surface **134** at its end.

Each of the arms **114**, **116** has a lug **136** mounted on its tab **122**. The lugs have inner surfaces **138** and outer surfaces **140**. The inner surfaces of the lugs are directed towards one another when the arms are in their deployed positions (which is the case as shown in the drawings).

The space which is defined by the inner surface **118** of the hub spar **112** is sized to receive the head part **100**. When the bearing surface **104** of head part is shaped as part of a sphere, the concave inner surface of the hub spar will also be shaped as part of a sphere. The pivot points **122**, **124** can be provided on the hub spar at its widest point. The width of the space which is defined by the hub spar is greatest between the pivot points. The width of the space which is defined between the extensions **128**, **130** is less than that between the pivot points.

The hub spar **112** and the arms **114**, **116** can be formed from a polymeric material, for example by injection moulding. Examples of a suitable polymeric material include certain polyamides, polyesters, polyolefins and poly (phenyl sulphones). A suitable material should be capable of withstanding conditions to which it is exposed during manufacture (including sterilisation) and use. A suitable material will often be resiliently deformable.

In use, the head part **100** of a femoral prosthesis component can be fitted into the alignment guide **110** when the arms **114**, **116** are in their retracted positions. This involves displacing the extensions **128**, **130** at the ends of hub spar **112** outwardly so that the widest part of the spherical bearing surface **104** is positioned beyond the extensions **128**, **130**,

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generally in line with the pivot points **122**, **124**. The resilient deformability of the material of the hub spar means that the head part is retained within the space **120** defined by the hub spar by means of the extensions.

Once the head part has been positioned within the space defined by the hub spar, the arms **114**, **116** are pivoted from their retracted positions to their deployed positions. This can be performed by a user by engaging the tabs **122**, for example with the finger and thumb of one hand. The inner surfaces **138** of the lugs **136** engage the chamfer surface portion **108a** of the head part at diametrically opposite points of the chamfer surface. The head part is then located between the concave surface of the hub spar which contacts the bearing surface and the lugs **136** which contact the assembly surface, the concave surface of the hub spar and the lugs being the bearing surface seating member and assembly surface seating members respectively.

The outer surfaces **140** of the lugs **136** and the flat surfaces **134** at the ends of the extensions are approximately coplanar. The assembly of the head part **100** and the alignment guide **110** can be placed on a surface (for example a table) with the outer surfaces **140** of the lugs **136** and the flat surfaces **134** at the ends of the extensions in contact with the table. The head part **100**, including in particular the assembly surface **108a** of the head part, is visible for inspection between the lugs and the extensions. The head part **100** can be manipulated by a user gripping the alignment guide, including positioning the head part so that the spigot on the stem part of the femoral component is received within the bore **106** in the head part. It is not necessary to contact the bearing surface of the head part.

The engagement between the hub spar **112** and the lugs **136** against the head part ensures that the head part is located centrally within the alignment guide with the first axis X1 that is defined by the bore in the head part being coincident with the second axis X2 defined by the centre of the socket **132** in the hub spar.

An impaction force can be applied to the head part to achieve a secure connection between it and the stem part through an impaction shaft **142** which extends through the bore in the sleeve component **134**. The sleeve component ensures that the longitudinal axis of the shaft extends perpendicular to the plane of the socket **132** in the hub spar, and is coincident with the second axis X2 defined by the centre of the socket. An impaction force that is directed through the impaction shaft **142** is therefore coincident with the first axis X1 that is defined by the bore in the head part. This ensures that when an impaction force is applied along the second axis X2 the force is directed along the first axis X1.

FIGS. **10** and **11** show an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part **200** of a femoral component such as that shown in FIG. **2** and an alignment guide **210** for use in assembling the stem and head parts of a femoral component. The head part **200** of the femoral component can be fitted to a stem part having a tapered spigot at its proximal end. The head part **200** has a bearing surface **204** and a bore **206** in an assembly surface **208**. The assembly surface includes a chamfer portion **208a**.

The alignment guide **210** comprises an axial portion in the form of a threaded sleeve **218**. The threaded sleeve defines a second axis X2 which, when the head part of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis component is mounted within the alignment guide, is coincident with the first axis X1 defined by the bore **206**. An arm **212** having proximal and distal ends

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214, **216** extends in a distal direction from the threaded sleeve **218**. The distal end **216** of the arm **212** has a U-shaped bracket **220**.

A threaded shaft **222** extends through the sleeve. The longitudinal axis of the shaft **222** is coincident with the longitudinal axis of the sleeve **218**. The thread on the shaft **222** engages the thread in the sleeve **218** so that the shaft can be advanced and retracted through the sleeve by rotating the shaft relative to the sleeve. The shaft has a first end **224** which is closer to the second end **216** of the arm **212**, and an opposite second end **226**.

The shaft **222** has a boss **226** at the end of the shaft which is closer to the second end **216** of the arm **212**. The boss is defined by a shoulder **228** on the shaft.

The alignment guide includes a circular seating member **230** which has a concave surface **232** defined by a part of a sphere on one side. It has a recess **234** on its opposite side which can receive the boss **226** on the end of the shaft. The curvature of the concave surface of the circular seating member corresponds approximately to the curvature of the bearing surface **204** of the head part **200** so that the head part fits against the seating member. The engagement between the recess on the seating member and the boss on the end of the shaft means that the seating member can remain stationary in contact with the bearing surface of the head part when the shaft is rotated.

The shaft **222** carries a socket member **236** at the second end **226** of the shaft. The socket member can receive the end of an impaction rod through which an impaction force can be applied. An impaction force can be applied using a mallet or using an instrument such as the one disclosed in EP-A-1707160. The external surface of the socket member **236** is ridged to facilitate gripping the socket member to twist it and the shaft.

The U-shaped bracket **220** carries a U-shaped seating member **238** which is also U-shaped. The space between the arms of the seating member is at least equal to the diameter of the bore **206** in the head part **200**. It will usually be slightly bigger than the diameter of the bore. The seating member is made from a polymeric material such as a poly (phenyl sulphone). The surface of the seating member which faces the proximal end of the arm is smooth.

In use, the head part **200** of a femoral prosthesis component can be fitted into the alignment guide **210** when the threaded shaft **222** is retracted so as to create sufficient space between the circular seating member **230** on the end of the shaft and the U-shaped seating member **238** at the second end of the arm **212**, so that the head part is positioned in the space between the two seating members **230**, **238**. The shaft is retracted in this way by rotating it relative to the sleeve **218**.

The threaded shaft **222** is then advanced through the sleeve **218** by rotating it relative to the shaft to drive the concave surface **232** of the circular seating member into contact with the bearing surface **204** of the head part **200**. This leads to surface to surface contact between the assembly surface **208** of the head part and the exposed face of the U-shaped seating member **238**. The head part becomes centred on the U-shaped seating member as the circular seating member becomes seated on the bearing surface of the head part by translating across the U-seating member due to the action of the circular seating member against the bearing surface. The first axis X1 which is defined by the bore **206** in the head part then extends through the centre of the circular seating member **230** and is coincident with the second axis X2 which is defined by the sleeve **218**.

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An impaction force can be applied to the head part to achieve a secure connection between it and the stem part through the shaft **222**. An impaction force that is directed through the impaction shaft, positioned within the sleeve **218**, is therefore coincident with the first axis X1 that is defined by the bore **206** in the head part **200**. This ensures that when an impaction force is applied to the shaft **222** along the second axis X2 the force is directed along the first axis X1.

FIGS. **12** and **13** show an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part **300** of a femoral component such as that shown in FIG. **2** and an alignment guide **310** for use in assembling the stem and head parts of a femoral component. The assembly has features in common with the assembly which is discussed above with reference to FIGS. **10** and **11**. The head part **300** of the femoral component can be fitted to a stem part having a tapered spigot at its proximal end. The head part **300** has a bearing surface **304** and a bore **306** in an assembly surface **308**. The assembly surface includes a chamfer portion **308a**.

The alignment guide **310** includes an axial portion in the form of a plain bore sleeve **318**. The plain bore sleeve defines a second axis X2 which, when the head part of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis component is mounted within the alignment guide, is coincident with the first axis X1 defined by the bore **306**. An arm **312** having proximal and distal ends **314**, **316** extends in a distal direction from the plain bore sleeve **318**. The distal end of the arm **314** includes a U-shaped bracket **320**.

A shaft **322** extends through the sleeve. The longitudinal axis of the shaft **322** is coincident with the longitudinal axis of the sleeve **318**. The shaft **322** can be advanced and retracted through the sleeve. The shaft has a first end **324** which is closer to the distal end **316** of the arm **312**, and an opposite second end **326**.

The shaft **322** has a boss **326** at the end of the shaft which is closer to the second end **316** of the arm **312**. The boss is defined by a shoulder **328** on the shaft. A spring **329** acts between an end of the sleeve **318** and the boss **326**.

The alignment guide includes a three fingered seating member which has a concave surface **331** defined by a part of a sphere on one side. The seating member has a central hub **332** and three fingers **333** extending radially from the hub which provide the concave surface **331**. The curvature of the concave surface of the circular seating member corresponds approximately to the curvature of the bearing surface **304** of the head part **300** so that the head part fits against the seating member. The seating member has a recess **334** on the side which is opposite to the concave surface which can receive the boss **324** on the end of the shaft. The engagement between the recess on the seating member and the boss on the end of the shaft means that the seating member can remain stationary in contact with the bearing surface of the head part when the shaft is rotated.

The shaft **322** carries a socket member **336** at the second end **326** of the shaft. The socket member can receive the end of rod through which an impaction force can be applied. The socket member **336** is fastened to the end of the shaft by means of a pin **337**. An impaction force can be applied using a mallet or using an instrument such as the one disclosed in BP-A-1707160. The socket member has a series of circumferential ridges which facilitate gripping the socket member to apply an axial force to the shaft, against the action of the spring **329**.

The U-shaped bracket **320** carries a U-shaped seating member **338** which is also U-shaped. The space between the arms of the seating member is at least equal to the diameter

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of the bore **306** in the head part **200**. It will usually be slightly bigger than the diameter of the bore. The seating member is made from a polymeric material such as a poly (phenyl sulphone). The surface of the seating member which faces the first end of the arm is smooth, allowing the head part to translate on the seating member as describe above.

In use, the head part **300** of a femoral prosthesis component can be fitted into the alignment guide **310** when the shaft **322** is retracted so as to create sufficient space between the circular seating member **330** on the end of the shaft and the U-shaped seating member **338** at the second end of the arm **312**, so that the head part is positioned in the space between the two seating members **330**, **338**. Retraction of the shaft **322** involves pulling it through the sleeve, compressing the spring **329** between the end of the sleeve **318** and the boss **326**. The shaft can be retracted in this way by gripping the socket member **336**. The extent of movement of the shaft relative to the sleeve is restricted by means of a pin **340** which is located in a bore in the sleeve and extends through a longitudinal slot in the shaft.

The shaft **322** is then released so that it advances through the sleeve **318**, acted on by the spring **329**, so that the circular seating member contacts the bearing surface **304** of the head part **300**. This leads to surface to surface contact between the assembly surface **308** of the head part and the exposed face of the U-shaped seating member **338**. The head part becomes centred on the U-shaped seating member as the circular seating member becomes seated on the bearing surface of the head part by translating across the U-seating member due to the action of the circular seating member against the bearing surface. The first axis X1 which is defined by the bore **306** in the head part then extends through the centre of the circular seating member **330** and is coincident with the second axis X2 which is defined by the sleeve **318**.

An impaction force can be applied to the head part to achieve a secure connection between it and the stem part through the shaft **322**. An impaction force that is directed through the impaction shaft **3222** is therefore coincident with the first axis X1 that is defined by the bore in the head part. This ensures that when an impaction force is applied along the second axis X2 the force is directed along the first axis X1.

FIGS. **14** and **15** show an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part **400** of a femoral component such as that shown in FIG. **2** and an alignment guide **410** for use in assembling the stem and head parts of a femoral component. The assembly has features in common with the assembly which is discussed above with reference to FIGS. **10** and **11**. The head part **400** of the femoral component can be fitted to a stem part having a tapered spigot at its proximal end. The head part **400** has a bearing surface **404** and a bore **406** in an assembly surface **408**. The assembly surface includes a chamfer portion **408a**.

The alignment guide **410** includes an axial portion in the form of a threaded sleeve **418**. An arm **412** which has proximal and distal ends **414**, **416** extends in a distal direction from the sleeve **418**. The distal end of the arm has a U-shaped slot **420** in the end wall **438**. The arm extends around an angle of arc measured around an axis extending between the proximal and distal ends of about 185 to 190°. It therefore forms a wall which encloses the space between the proximal and distal ends on one side of the alignment guide. The wall can be provided with openings (not shown) to make a head part located within the alignment guide more visible. The arm is made from a polymeric material by moulding. The material is capable of resilient deformation.

A threaded shaft **422** extends through the sleeve. The longitudinal axis of the shaft **422** is coincident with the longitudinal axis of the sleeve **418**. The thread on the shaft engages the thread in the sleeve **418** so that the shaft can be advanced and retracted through the sleeve by rotating the shaft relative to the sleeve. The shaft has a first end **424** which is closer to the proximal end **416** of the arm **412**, and an opposite second end **426**.

The shaft **422** has a **423** bore extending through it which is open at each of the first and second ends **424**, **426**. The shaft has a ridged collar at the second end which allows the shaft to be gripped in order to rotate it relative to the sleeve **418**.

The end wall **428** of the shaft **322** surrounding the open end of the bore **423** is shaped so that it presents a generally concave surface which is an annular portion of a sphere. The end wall is then a circular seating member. The curvature of the concave surface of the circular seating member corresponds approximately to the curvature of the bearing surface **404** of the head part **400** so that the head part fits against the seating member. The engagement between the recess on the seating member and the boss on the end of the shaft means that the seating member can remain stationary in contact with the bearing surface of the head part when the shaft is rotated.

The space between the arms of the U-shaped slot **420** is at least equal to the diameter of the bore **406** in the head part **400**. It will usually be slightly bigger than the diameter of the bore.

In use, the head part **400** of a femoral prosthesis component can be fitted into the alignment guide **410** when the threaded shaft **422** is retracted so as to create sufficient space between the circular bearing surface seating member provided by the end **428** of the shaft and the assembly surface seating member provided by the end wall **438** at the distal end of the arm **412**. The end wall **438** provides an assembly surface seating member for the head part so that the head part is positioned in the space between the two seating members **430**, **438**. The shaft is retracted in this way by rotating it relative to the sleeve **418**.

The threaded shaft **422** is then advanced through the sleeve **418** by rotating it relative to the shaft to drive the end wall **428** of the shaft into contact with the bearing surface **404** of the head part **400**. This leads to surface to surface contact between the assembly surface **408** of the head part and the end wall **438** of the second end of the arm. The head part becomes centred on the end wall as the circular seating member becomes seated on the bearing surface of the head part by translating across the U-seating member due to the action of the circular seating member against the bearing surface. The first axis X1 which is defined by the bore **406** in the head part is then coincident with the second axis X2 which is defined by the sleeve **418**.

An impact force can be applied to the head part to achieve a secure connection between it and the stem part through the shaft **322**. An impact force that is directed through the threaded shaft **412** is therefore coincident with the first axis X1 that is defined by the bore in the head part. This ensures that when an impact force is applied along the second axis X2 the force is directed along the first axis X1.

An impact force can be applied to the head part through an impact shaft which is inserted through the bore **423** in the threaded shaft **422**. The longitudinal axis of the bore in the threaded shaft is coincident with the second axis X2 as defined by sleeve **418**. In turn the second axis X2 is coincident with the first axis X1 defined by the bore **406**

in the head part. This helps to ensure that the impact force is directed along the first axis X1.

FIGS. **16** to **18** show an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part **500** of a femoral component such as that shown in FIG. **2** and an alignment guide **510** for use in assembling the stem and head parts of a femoral component. The assembly has features in common with the assembly which is discussed above with reference to FIGS. **14** and **15**. The head part **500** of the femoral component can be fitted to a stem part having a tapered spigot at its proximal end. The head part **500** has a bearing surface **504** and a bore **506** in an assembly surface **508**. The assembly surface includes a chamfer portion **508a**.

The alignment guide **510** includes an axial portion in the form of a plain bore sleeve **518** having a longitudinal axis X2. First and second arms **512**, **514** extend from the distal portion of the sleeve **518** such that a space is formed between each arm. The inner surface of each arm has a contact surface, the shape of which substantially corresponds to that of the bearing surface of the head part of an orthopaedic joint prosthesis. This facilitates a nesting fit between the bearing surface of the head part and the contact surface of each arm. When the bearing surface of the head is convex, the contact surface of each arm can be concave. As shown in FIGS. **16b** and **16c**, retention pinch points, can be provided on the contact surface of each of the first and second arms **512**, **514**. The retention pinch points are preferably located at or above the equator of the femoral head component. The retention pinch points aid in the stable retention of the femoral head component within the alignment guide and also apply a force to push the femoral head component downwardly towards the assembly surface seating member. The retention pinch points can take the form of an inwardly protruding rib **524a**, **524b** (as shown in FIG. **16a**) or an angled straight face **526a**, **526b** (as shown in FIG. **16c**).

FIGS. **17a** and **17b** show cross sectional views of the assembly shown in FIG. **16a** taken along the longitudinal axis X2. FIG. **17a** shows the retention of a 36 mm femoral head with a -2.0 offset retained within the alignment guide. FIG. **17b** shows the retention of a 36 mm femoral head with a +8.5 offset retained within the same alignment guide. The ability of the same alignment guide to retain femoral heads with different offsets is achieved by the provision of the retentions pinch point **524a**, **524b**.

Each arm **512**, **514** has a proximal end **516** and a distal end **520**. The distal end of each arm joins to form a U-shaped bracket **522**. The U-shaped bracket carries a U-shaped assembly surface seating member which is also U-shaped. The space between the arms of the seating member is at least equal to the diameter of the bore **506**. The surface of the seating member which contacts the assembly surface is smooth. The alignment guide is made from a polymeric material by for example moulding or machining. The material is capable of resilient deformation.

The alignment guide can be provided in a range of sizes, each size of guide being specific for a particular size of head part. For example, the alignment guide shown is configured for use with a 28 mm diameter femoral head. In some constructions, the head part is mounted within, and packaged with the alignment guide. This is particularly advantageous because it minimises the amount of handling of the head part prior to implantation. This reduces the risk of a breach of sterility of the head part and any damage to the bearing surface.

As shown in FIG. **16a**, the head part **500** of a femoral prosthesis component can be fitted into the alignment guide

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510 by press-fitting the femoral bead between the arms 512, 514. The resilient deformity of the material of the arms 512, 514 means that the head part is retained within the space defined between the arms. The head part is positioned such that there is surface to surface contact between the assembly surface 508 of the head part and the inner surface of the U-shaped assembly surface seating member. As shown in FIG. 18, an impaction force can be applied to the head part through an impaction shaft 522 which is inserted through the bore of the sleeve 518. The distal end of the impaction shaft is shaped to correspond to that of the bearing surface. When the bearing surface of the head is convex, the distal end of the impaction shaft can be concave. The distal end of the impaction shaft is brought into contact with the bearing surface and functions as a bearing surface seating member. The sleeve defines the orientation of the impaction shaft relative to the axis which is defined by the bore 506. The sleeve ensures that the longitudinal axis of the impaction shaft is coincident with the second axis X2 of the sleeve. In turn, the second axis X2 is coincident with the first axis X1 which is defined by the bore in the head part. This ensures that when an impaction force is applied along the second axis X2 the force is directed along the first axis X1.

FIGS. 19 and 20 show an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part 600 of a femoral component such as that shown in FIG. 2 and an alignment guide 610 for use in assembling the stem and head parts of a femoral component. The assembly has features in common with the assembly which is discussed above with reference to FIGS. 16 and 17. The outer surface of the distal portion of each arm is provided with a series of grooves which aid in the handling of the alignment guide. A depression 614 is provided on the outer surface of the sleeve. The depression 614 is dimensioned for receipt of a user's thumb. This also improves the handling of the alignment guide.

FIGS. 21 and 22 show an orthopaedic joint prosthesis assembly which includes a head part 700 of a femoral component such as that shown in FIG. 2 and an alignment guide 710 for use in assembling the stem and head parts of a femoral component. The assembly has features in common with the assembly which is discussed above with reference to FIGS. 16 and 17. The sleeve 712 is provided with circumferentially arranged grooves on the outer surface. The grooves aid in the handling of the alignment guide. A depression 714 is provided on the outer surface of the sleeve. The depression is dimensioned for receipt of a user's thumb. This also improves the handling of the alignment guide.

The assembly surface seating member which engages the assembly surface of the head part can be essentially planar as discussed above in relation to at least some of the devices shown in the drawings. The assembly surface seating member could be formed with at least one formation defining at least part of a circle, which can engage the assembly surface around at least part of the periphery of the head part. The formation might be U-shaped so that its shape matches that of the seating member, with the base of the "U" being shaped as a part (especially about half) of a circle. The assembly surface seating member can be formed with a series of formations (for example at least two or at least three or at least four) which can engage the assembly surfaces on head parts of different sizes. This can be appropriate in relation to the devices shown in FIGS. 10 and 11, FIGS. 12 and 13, and FIGS. 14 and 15.

What is claimed:

1. An orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly which comprises:

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a head part of an orthopedic joint prosthesis component, which has a spherical bearing surface for articulation with a corresponding joint surface, and an assembly surface having a bore formed in it for receiving a spigot on another part of the orthopedic joint prosthesis, said bore having a first axis that extends perpendicular to the assembly surface, and in which there is a discontinuity at an interface between the bearing surface and the assembly surface, the said assembly surface being arranged on a plane which is parallel to, or contains, a plane which is defined by an opening to the bore in the head part when the head part is viewed from one side in cross-section, and

an alignment guide comprising an axial portion defining a second axis coincident with the first axis, such that when an impaction force is applied along the second axis the force is directed along the first axis, the axial portion comprising:

a plain bore sleeve; and

a pair of cantilevered arms that extend from a distal portion of the sleeve such that a space is formed between each arm,

wherein each arm comprises a proximal end secured to the distal portion of the sleeve, a distal end opposite the proximal end, and an inner surface that has a contact surface shaped to correspond to the bearing surface of the head part of the orthopedic joint prosthesis, such that when the head part is mounted within the guide a nesting fit is formed between the bearing surface of the head part and the contact surface of each arm, and

wherein the distal end of each arm joins to form a U-shaped bracket which carries a U-shaped assembly surface seating member configured to engage the assembly surface of the head part of the orthopedic joint prosthesis so as to retain the head part within the alignment guide when the head part is mounted within the guide.

2. The orthopedic prosthesis assembly of claim 1, wherein the contact surface of each arm is concave.

3. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 1, wherein a retention pinch point is provided on the contact surface of each arm.

4. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 3, wherein the retention pinch point comprises an angled straight face.

5. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 3, wherein the retention pinch point comprises an inwardly protruding rib.

6. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 1, wherein the bore in the assembly surface of the head part has a diameter, and wherein a space between each arm of the U-shaped assembly surface seating member is at least equal to the diameter of the bore.

7. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 1, wherein an outer surface of the distal portion of each arm includes a series of grooves, and an outer surface of the sleeve includes a depression dimensioned for receipt of a user's thumb, the series of grooves and the depression aid in the handling of the alignment guide.

8. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 1, wherein an outer surface of the sleeve includes a series of grooves and also a depression dimensioned for receipt of a user's thumb, the series of grooves and the depression aid in the handling of the alignment guide.

9. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 1, wherein the alignment guide is made from a polymeric material.

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10. The orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly of claim 9, wherein the polymeric material is capable of resilient deformation.

11. An orthopedic joint prosthesis assembly comprising:
 a part of an orthopedic joint prosthesis having a spigot;
 a head part of an orthopedic joint prosthesis component,
 which has a spherical bearing surface for articulation
 with a corresponding joint surface, and an assembly
 surface having a bore formed in it for receiving the
 spigot on another part of the orthopedic joint prosthe-
 sis, said bore having a first axis that extends perpen-
 dicular to the assembly surface, and in which there is a
 discontinuity at an interface between the bearing sur-
 face and the assembly surface, the assembly surface
 being arranged on a plane which is parallel to, or
 contains, a plane which is defined by an opening to the
 bore in the head part when the head part is viewed from
 one side in cross-section;

an alignment guide comprising an axial portion defining
 a second axis coincident with the first axis, such that
 when an impaction force is applied along the second
 axis the force is directed along the first axis, the axial
 portion comprising:

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a plain bore sleeve; and

a pair of cantilevered arms that extend from a distal
 portion of the sleeve such that a space is formed
 between each arm;

wherein each arm of the alignment guide comprises a
 proximal end secured to the distal portion of the sleeve,
 a distal end opposite the proximal end, and an inner
 surface that has a contact surface shaped to substan-
 tially correspond to the bearing surface of the head part
 of the orthopedic joint prosthesis, such that when the
 head part is mounted within the guide a nesting fit is
 formed between the bearing surface of the head part
 and the contact surface of each arm, and

wherein the distal end of each arm joins to form a
 U-shaped bracket which carries a U-shaped assembly
 surface seating member configured to engage the
 assembly surface of the head part of the orthopedic
 joint prosthesis so as to retain the head part within the
 alignment guide when the head part is mounted within
 the guide.

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